

BOOK EIGHT
WICKED GAMES



Devil
IN THE WATERS

KT MORRISON

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About the Author

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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All characters are over the age of eighteen.

WICKED GAMES

A Devil In The Waters Novella

Book 8

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I

Monday, August 17

Geysers

First thing Monday morning in her office after dealing with emails, Kimmy called Amy.

Quarter past three in the London afternoon, Amy picked up, sounding lively. “I’ve been dying to talk to you. How was Cayman?”

“Hot.”

“I’ll bet,” Amy said.

Sly Amy, right to the core. No different from how she was in those supercharged days after her brief high school fling began with Devlin Stone.

Kimmy asked Amy how she was doing and Amy told her, yeah-yeah, she was doing amazing and get to the point already.

“What do you want to know?”

Amy said, “Why on earth you might tell me the sex with Devlin Stone was ho-fucking-hum, chum.”

“I don’t know,” Kimmy said, “I guess I always thought it would be better.”

“Better? Well, what? how was it, how’d it happen? Tell me.”

“It’s happened a few times—”

“Goddamn it, why is this the first I’m hearing of it?” Amy cackled a sharp sound.

“Like I said, things have been crazy here.”

“Are you all right, though? Josh doesn’t know . . .”

“Of course not. What, you think I was going to tell him?”

“My goodness, Kimmy Chang being bad,” Amy said, adding a humorously nefarious spin to the word bad.

“See, when you say something like that, it makes my stomach turn. I hate myself.” And the truth was, the weekend getaway in Cayman seemed otherworldly and distant, like the events had happened to someone else and she’d only heard about it secondhand. All morning her stomach had flipped over and knotted, and when her mind would flash back to some of the weekend’s imagery, she would get a sickly thrill below her belly she didn’t like. There was a lump of regret too, choking at the back of her throat. The paths she’d taken were dark and scary, and she could tell herself she was brave and—more importantly—capable, but the truth was she should never go down these dangerous roads. But there was no turning back now.

Amy said, “Why on earth would you hate yourself?”

“What do you think?—for cheating on Josh.” She hated saying it out loud.

Amy clucked her tongue. “Just don’t tell him.”

“I wish it were that simple.”

“It could be. And honestly, it will be. Just get some time behind you and your feeling bad about it will go away.”

“I don’t think it was worth it,” she lamented.

“Oh, this? Why’d you tell me it wasn’t what you thought?”

“Because it wasn’t.”

“We’re talking about sex with Devlin, yeah?”

“I know, yes. Yes, we are.”

“It’s hard to believe you’d say that. You’re putting me on.”

“Look, it was fine, like I said, I just expected, I don’t know, more.”

“More what? I’ve seen what you’re getting at home and at least you have to admit the guy is packing a magic stick.”

“Don’t be cruel.”

“It’s not cruel,” Amy said, “it’s true. I saw Josh’s little boner, and it wasn’t impressive. I’ve dumped two men who didn’t have what I want down there and—”

“But what if that’s not what I want? What if there’s more I want?”

“Love? Kimmy, Devlin’s not—”

“Not love. Just more. I don’t know what you’ve got against Josh, but I’d appreciate you talking about my husband with a little more respect.” Said the adulteress.

“I’m sorry, Kimmy, I swear, I’m just joking around. There’s nothing wrong with what Josh’s got, but you have to admit Devlin is h-u-n and fucking -g.”

“Yeah, he is,” she huffed morosely.

“What, like he wasn’t tender, then?”

“It’s not tenderness, it’s . . . I don’t know, Amy, I expected to be swept away.”

“Like a romance?”

“Not love. I just—”

“I think you need to shag him again.”

“It’s been more than once.”

“You fucked him more than once?”

“A few times.”

“Gaw,” Amy scoffed. “Tell me, come on.”

“Where are you right now?”

“At the gallery.”

“In your office?”

“With my feet up. I’ve been waiting for this call all day. I worried you wouldn’t call me.”

Kimmy could picture her wearing a suit with a low-cut blouse; black or steel, stiletto heels up on a glass desk top; looking severe in that sharp new crimson bob she wore. “Things have been crazy here.”

“Tell me about it. I mean it, tell me all about it.”

She told Amy about the time in the car outside her gym and Amy laughed. “Just to see if it fit?” Amy thought that was hilarious, and Amy’s amusement only proved to Kimmy how gullible she’d been that first time, even though she’d had agency—or at least she thought she had—the re-telling of it made her sound immature. She told Amy about the cargo container by the port and Amy said, “Have you ever thought about doing it in a bed? Maybe that’s what’s going wrong.”

She sighed and admitted: “We did it in a bed. In a suite at the Royal York.”

Amy emitted a low whistle of appreciation.

“Look, I mean it wasn’t terrible, it’s just, I don’t know, maybe I’d built it up in my head to be more than it really ended up being.”

“So, it’s done.”

“No. He showed up in Cayman—”

“Devlin did?”

“Yeah.”

Amy loved it and broke out laughing. “Fucking devil he is, isn’t he?”

“He is a devil.”

“You fucked him there?”

“I did.”

Amy was incredulous. “Josh was with you.”

“I know. I got away.”

“Oh my god, Kimmy,” Amy laughed, walking around her office now, the phone’s mic moving away from her mouth a moment as she made more sounds of disbelief. “Something tells me while you say it’s not great, it is great. You keep going back for more.”

She chuckled now too, as though she didn’t understand her own behavior. “I just keep hoping one of these times it’ll be like how you described.”

“I really wish I was there in Toronto. I wish I was there to guide you through this.”

I wish I trusted you enough to have you here. “I guess I sound like I need guidance.”

“You do.”

“So what should I do?”

“Kimmy, stick with it. It’s the advice I always give no matter the subject, but in this case I really do mean it, love.”

Now the kicker: “I don’t know if it’s worth it.”

Amy was honest: “I can’t believe you’d say that. You’re curious enough to step out on Josh a few times, but you’re not sure if it’s worth it? If Devlin isn’t rocking your world, I honestly want to know what the hell Josh has been doing to you. Maybe I’ve underestimated him.”

“Maybe you have.”

“I don’t think I have.” Then, before Kimmy could chastise Amy for being negative toward Josh, she said, “You will not find a single man anywhere in this world who’s better in the sack than Devlin.”

“You’ve slept with them all, have you?” They both laughed, then Kimmy said, “If you’re so amazed by Devlin, you come back and take over for me.”

“I would if I could, but I’m all the way here, Kimmy. And it’s you that Devlin wants.”

And that was the whole beginning of what had become six whirlwind weeks that changed her life. Devlin had wanted Kimmy Waters. And how did that happen?

“I’ll figure it out,” she said.

“Don’t sound so sad, Kimmy. It’s not exactly torture being with Devlin. How’s the new job?”

“Pretty great, actually.”

“You’re happier there?”

“Than where, immigration? Yes, for sure.”

“Seems like things have improved for you since Tiffany’s party, you ask me.”

Things had definitely improved. But there was a cost. There was a sweet and loving man, about a hundred-fifty pounds, who was smart and dedicated and would do anything for her. The cost was that man's future.

"It's been a wild six weeks, and yeah, I'm pretty happy about where things are headed."

"That's the spirit."

"When will you be back?"

"In Toronto? No plans. Why don't you come out here? You've got the bucks now. Come stay with me for a week and we'll have a real hen's."

"I might do it, you know."

"I'd love it, Kimmy. I miss you. A lot. It's been years, and London's amazing, but I do miss my friends from home."

"It has been a long time," she agreed. And things change over time.

Even when they'd been best friends in high school, there was a dissimilarity between them. They were both smart and dedicated to school, but while Kimmy was a shy and mousy bookworm who enjoyed staying at home and binge-watching Korean soaps, Amy was a go-getter, a social butterfly wannabe who would ingratiate herself to anyone she thought had status. Amy had always wanted a more glamorous lifestyle, to be part of a better crowd. And Amy could be nasty.

Though Amy had never been cruel to Kimmy, she'd seen it firsthand. Amy didn't let people get in her way. And, in the end, Amy had fled their friendship for greener pastures. That was cruel in its own way.

"Any time you want, love. Just let me know. I'd love to see you again and spend some time having fun like we used to."

"Studying together?"

Amy laughed, then said, “I think my studying days are over. But it’s paid off, don’t you think?”

“You’re happy there?”

“Ecstatic.”

So she’d tell Amy untruths about Devlin. Why? To discover where those truths would pop up. Like flooding a groundhog’s hole, waiting for nearby geysers to show where the exits are. If Amy and Devlin still communicated, then Devlin will hear of how underwhelming Kimmy is describing his lovemaking behind his back. Devlin will react. What would he think? That Kimmy was duplicitous? That she was as upwardly mobile-minded as Amy and was just fucking him to improve her bank account? Devlin wasn’t likely that stupid, but he would have a tell.

And what would it mean if Devlin and Amy still communicated and Kimmy didn’t know about it? Terrible, terrible things.

They talked a while about London and how things were going there. She told Amy about the job with Devlin and all about the weekend in Cayman. Amy didn’t press for the gory details about sex with Devlin. Had she already been told by Devlin? But it was a workday, so she didn’t spend too long chatting. Before they hung up, Amy made her promise she would stay in touch.

“I want to know how it’s progressing, Kimmy. Anytime you want to talk, call me. For advice or whatever. And just in general, call me. You hear? I want to know what’s going on with you. I think about you.”

“I think about you too.”

They said their goodbyes and ta-tas and then closed off the call.

Kimmy checked her watch. It was past ten-thirty and Devlin hadn’t showed yet. Awful as the things she was doing were, she loved them. All that foggy talk of not thinking Devlin was great in bed was, of course, total hogwash. There was a lunchtime date today with Devlin. They were going to go to his

apartment. A knot of lusty desire formed between her legs that got her flexing her thighs. There was a hungry need for her boss. Even the thought of meeting him for the tryst had got her heated, sitting at her desk mid-morning on a sunny Monday. It was going to be impossible getting anything done before lunch.

But she adjusted her skirt, scooted in her leather chair and woke her computer up again. Then fidgeted where she sat. She wasn't wearing underwear, plus the push-through knobs on her garters were digging into her flesh.

II

Tuesday, August 18

Avengers

Devlin was running a game on him, and he didn't care. And he had little fear. The feeling was indescribable.

Tuesday night, not a care in the world, and here he was enjoying a night out with his friends. Right after work they hit the Kelsey's for a beer, then over to the Cineplex. Marvel mayhem. Now they were in the Montana's having an after action report on the Avengers and enjoying a juicy prime rib like men were supposed to.

"Not as good as the steak in Cayman," he said, "but it'll do." Steve rolled his eyes.

Meyer said, "I can go outside and scoop up a bunch of grit from the parking lot and throw it around you. You can pretend you're on the beach."

With a pooched lower lip, he lamented in Homer Simpson's voice, "But it won't be Caribbean sand."

They ate their steaks and their fries, and they drank two pitchers of Labatt Blue between the three of them.

"You're not the only one who had a great weekend," Meyer said, laying an arm over the back of the banquette seating and looking content.

Josh said, "Oh yeah?"

Steve said, "Meyer and I went to Paris this weekend."

Josh said, "Romantic getaway?"

Meyer said, “I don’t think we’re there yet, Josh, where we’d call it romantic”—putting romantic in air quotes and looking a little giddy—“but things are progressing.”

Steve swooned and batted his eyes at Meyer. “I’m so glad you feel the same,” he said breathily.

Meyer blew him a kiss and Josh laughed a good laugh, topping up his beer.

“No, really,” Meyer said, “I did something finally.”

“What’s that?” He gestured with the pitcher to Meyer’s dwindling beer glass and Meyer nodded he wanted more.

Meyer said, “I called up Quinn.”

“Hey-ey,” Josh and Steve both crooned at the same time.

“Yeah, we’re going to go out—”

“Where are you taking her?”

“Play date. With the kids. We’re going out next Saturday during the day. To the park, and whatever.”

“It’s a start,” Steve said.

“It’s a good date.”

“Not really a date,” Meyer said.

“Which is the best kind of date,” Josh said.

“That’s how you sneak up on them,” Steve said.

Later, when Steve went off to the can, it was the first time he’d been alone with his cousin. He said, “Fucking Cayman was unbelievable.”

“As unbelievable as you considering not going?”

“I was being difficult.”

“You? Nah, never. You’re a straight shooter.”

“Fuck you. But it was, really. Like life-changing.”

“That sunburn is life-changing?”

Josh squeezed his sore nose. It wasn’t too red, but he had got sun. “You know . . .” He paused, wondering if he should say it—but he really wanted to talk about this, bounce it off someone. “Her boss showed up there.”

Meyer looked his way and showed an expression like he was unsure if Josh was kidding or not. That simple reaction got his guts squirming. It was weird that Devlin showed. They’d somehow made the best of it, but it wasn’t right.

Josh nodded now, rotating his beer glass clockwise with his fingers, eyes down, and watching his hands work.

“What do you mean, he showed up there? When?”

“On the Saturday.”

Meyer’s brow furrowed with concern. “And what happened?”

That got him smiling, thinking about what happened. “Crazy stuff, man.”

Meyer leaned back, amused. He smirked, still frowning. “Like what?”

Josh looked around, then leaned forward on the table with his elbows.

“Well, when he showed up, I was like ballistic. I wanted to go crazy, but I swear to God, I just played it cool.”

“Yeah, so what happened?”

“It was tough, because I was really mad—I still can’t believe I handled it. But . . . Devlin was clearly flirting with Kimmy. Like doing it right in front of me.”

Meyer looked disgusted. “That guy’s an asshole. Why does Kimmy work for him?”

“The money. But listen: the flirting makes me mad and I go inside. Kimmy follows me in and says, ‘I like it when you stand up to him. Why don’t you come out and flirt with me.’”

Meyer smiled, adjusted his ball cap. “I love Kimmy.”

“I love her too. So I’m thinking about it, and I go right. This is my wife, for fuck’s sake. So I go out there, and you have to understand, Josh and I were supposed to go out to dinner. Devlin just kind of shows up—it’s our weekend alone in Cayman—but he’s going to meet her for a drink. Kimmy brings him back to the villa, and the next thing you know, he’s taking us out for dinner. But it’s Kimmy and I who’re supposed to go out for dinner. Anyway, Kimmy’s waiting for me to flirt with her, and I do it. I flirt with her right in front of Devlin. And she makes it clear—like she comes right to me, starts making out with me, tells Devlin, tells her boss, ‘We’re going to need a little time before we go out to dinner.’” This got him smiling and excited, and he looked around to see if Steve was coming back yet—but at this point, he didn’t even care. “She brings me into our villa and we have”—now he looked around again, making sure no one could overhear—“sex. But like crazy sex. Loud sex. Kimmy is so loud. She’s doing it for him, for Devlin to hear.”

Meyer curled the brim of his hat and held it there, closing himself off in Josh’s story, and embarrassed to hear intimate details of his cousin’s sex life. “This is amazing.”

“I love how you’re smiling.”

Meyer said, “It’s making me smile. I don’t like this Devlin guy, but I like what Kimmy did.”

“Me too. And Jesus, Meyer, I don’t know how to tell you. The sex . . .”

Meyer grimaced under the shade of his cap, but he said, “You can tell me.”

“You sure it’s okay?”

He nodded, still looking unsure. “Yeah, go ahead.”

Josh couldn’t help smiling, getting wriggly in his chair, talking with his hands, saying, “Sex with her recently has been like out of this world. I don’t know what’s going on between us, but she is like, I don’t know”—he ran his hands through his hair, laughing—“a tiger. Maybe it’s because of this guy being around all the time. I don’t know what it is, but . . . We’re doing it like all the time. And I can make her . . .”

Meyer showed a face like he wasn’t sure if he wanted to hear more, but made direct eye contact. “Continue.”

Josh couldn’t help himself, whispering, “Squirt.” Then felt bad when it was said. But it had to be said.

“All right,” Meyer said, putting up his hands in surrender and sitting back from the table. “I didn’t want to know that.” He put a hand over his stomach like he felt queasy.

Josh broke out laughing. It was uncontrollable. “Sorry, sorry. But like I’m just . . . I feel like a superhero.”

“Well, good for you, Joshy-boy. I’m glad you finally found your superpower. Maybe we’ll see you up on the big screen someday with the rest of the Avengers.”

Steve came out of nowhere, sidling into the booth smelling like hand soap. “What’s Josh’s super power?”

Meyer said, “You don’t want to know.”

“I don’t?”

Josh shrugged his shoulders, beaming, taking a big thirsty drink of beer.

Steve persisted, showing some hurt he was left out. “What’s his super power?—come on now.”

Meyer looked up at the timber rafters of the restaurant, then said, “He says he can make Kimmy squirt.”

“Mey-er,” Josh scolded, hunching and looking around to see if it was overheard.

It took a beat for Steve to get what Meyer meant by that. Then he raised his eyebrows. “You’re right,” he said, “I didn’t want to know.”

He hoped neither of them were trying to picture what Kimmy looked like when she came so hard she squirted (though he could tell them if they wanted). He said, “Now you know my superpower.”

Meyer said, “I think that calls for another pitcher in celebration.”

“And this one’s on Josh—”

“Gross, so he can get us wet now, too?”

They all broke out laughing and ordered another pitcher as the server passed.

Then Steve said, “Jesus, what else I miss?”

Meyer said, “Kimmy’s boss showed up in Cayman when they were there.”

“No shit?” His features stretched long with open-jawed incredulity.

Josh showed Meyer a shut-the-fuck-up face, and Meyer shrugged like it was no big deal.

“That guy you mean, the one we saw at the Dragon on Wednesday?”

Josh said, “She only has one boss.”

“No, I know, I just wanted to make sure we were on the same page.”

“We’re on the same page.”

Meyer said, “Steve, it’s the guy, remember you had Josh’s knees shaking before his surprise party, thinking maybe he was right?”

Steve played along, “Oh, that guy, the one who took Kimmy to the Royal York—”

“That’s the one,” Meyer said.

“Right, the one who uses her maiden’s name because it’s Chinese.”

“And Kimmy’s secretary thought Josh was Chinese,” Meyer said. The two of them got a big kick out of ribbing him.

Then Meyer said to Steve, “That guy, that very same guy, showed up in Cayman this weekend.”

Steve’s smile shrank. “He did for real?”

Meyer nodded and laughed. “And Josh said he was flirting with Kimmy.”

Steve didn’t like it one bit, scowling aside at Josh, saying, “Du-ude.”

“What? It was fine. We sorted him out.”

Steve said, “Sorted him out how?”

Josh felt confident, rolled his eyes and gestured for his cousin to go ahead and tell him.

Meyer leaned close and said, “Kimmy got Josh to flirt with her in front of him, then she told her boss, ‘Oh hey, give us a minute before dinner,’ and she took Joshy into their villa and had sex with him, getting super loud with the windows open so the guy could hear them. Then I guess she played sprinkler and Josh here ran in and out of it like it was a hot summer day.”

Their pitcher arrived, and they laid back on the dirty talk until the server was gone again. They were all buzzing pretty good right now.

Steve said, “Kimmy asked you to do that?”

“Do what, flirt with her?”

“Yeah, but also to have sex so he could hear.”

He nodded, expectant, seeing Steve was going somewhere with this. When Steve said no more, Josh asked, “What?”

Steve shook his head, mouth down-turned, saying, “No, nothing.”

Josh said to Meyer, “What?”

Meyer looked to Steve. “Beats me. Steve?”

“It’s nothing,” Steve said, trying to brush it off. But it was useless because both Josh and Meyer were rabid now.

“What is it?”

“Nothing,” Steve reiterated, stressed. Then: “So, what? How far away was this guy, what’s his name, Devlin?”

“Like down at the beach. We’re up at the villa. Maybe, I don’t know, like half a soccer field.”

“Oh okay,” Steve said, like the answer changed his mind.

“What the heck were you thinking?” Meyer asked, roused by the dirty possible connotations Steve might be thinking.

But what would that be, that what, Kimmy wanted Devlin for a threesome or something, her sex sounds were like a siren’s call?

The moment got uncomfortable, and the table felt quiet even though the restaurant was at full capacity. Josh couldn’t let it go, hating that his friend might harbor some ill thought about what happened in the Caribbean. He’d been there. The experience had been transformative. He said, “Go on and say it. Kimmy opened the windows so her boss could hear us.”

Steve nodded. “She opened the windows?”

“Yeah.”

“Oh. It’s nothing, it’s . . .”

“What?”

“Like, why would she want him to hear?”

There was more to the story. More that he would keep to himself. “Are you trying to get me going again?”

Steve laughed. “No, definitely not. I’m not. It’s just, maybe . . .”

“Maybe what?”

Though he was reluctant, Steve at last said, “Maybe she’s trying to make this Devlin guy jealous. That’s all I was thinking.”

Meyer and Josh stared at him with blank expressions, and Steve looked at each of their faces in turn. “Sorry,” Steve said, “that was stupid. That’s why I didn’t want to say it.”

It hurt to hear, and damn if those words didn’t polish a new shine on that brassy knob of strange sexuality within him, thinking of Kimmy having desires for Devlin Stone. He said, “No, I get it, I hear you. But it wasn’t like that. Trust me, I was there and there’s nobody more paranoid than me, right?”

Both Meyer and Steve chuckled and smiled in nodding agreement. Steve said, “I’m gonna grab us some nachos. I think we need to sober up a little.” he got up from the table and headed to where he could see their server over at one of the stations.

Meyer said, “Don’t listen to him.”

“No, don’t worry, he can’t get to me.”

“He’s not trying to, he just didn’t realize how it sounded.”

“You had to be there—”

Meyer said, “No fucking way—if I had to hear you and Kimmy having sex, I’d drown myself in the ocean.”

“Sea.”

“Whatever, in the sea.”

And now here came that sickly stomach-dropping thrill of sexual worry. Kimmy wanting Devlin to hear her get fucked, not to thrill her husband so his bully knew her sexuality was satisfied, but to turn his bully on, to make Devlin lust after her. He chewed his lower lip and did his best to fight back those awful feelings returning, but his stomach tightened and despite himself, he could feel his cock thickening at the terrible thought.

III



Friday, August 21

Eileen

Something was up, she was sure of it. If she checked her phone at the table, though, her father would kill her.

Pop, at the head of the table, looked more pleased than she could remember him in a long time. Both his daughters were at the dinner table together with him, and it had been a long time since that happened. He wore a thin, wide smile that really did cheer her heart; tonight he'd worn a pressed button-down collar shirt and a light vest. He looked good. He looked happy. It wasn't just the brandy that Josh and Pop kept drinking, she also recognized it was her new success and the trip to Grand Cayman she'd earned herself as a treat, after only a month at her new job.

Across from her, Eileen, her sister, wasn't so pleased. Now the shoe was on the other foot.

Eileen and her husband, both dentists, opened their new practice two years ago, and it was all she used to hear about when she visited Pop. To the point she looked for ways to avoid dinner dates and family functions. It wasn't so terrible now. And there was a small but sick pleasure she took from Pop's boasting to Eileen about Kimmy's success. It wasn't envy on Eileen's face—Eileen and Robert were doing just fine out in Calgary, thank you very much—it was discontent. For the first time in a long time Eileen wasn't so far ahead in first place, and her sister didn't like being challenged.

Despite the pervasive woolly annoyance that tickled the back of her neck—fucking Devlin—and made her squirm with her own measure of grievance, she did enjoy watching Eileen deal with her older sister's new job. Eileen

wasn't her usual effusive self, fawning over Pop and basking in his attention.

Susan asked Kimmy, "How was the flight? I've never been on a private plane before."

It made Kimmy wonder if Susan was ingratiating herself, like maybe Susan could see that Eileen wasn't the center of attention for once and maybe Susan would help Kimmy out—Kimmy was the closest daughter and most frequent visitor to the man who was Susan's boyfriend (even if Pop wouldn't admit it).

Eileen said, "It wasn't private, it was shared."

Kimmy agreed. "It's not my boss's plane."

"Still," Susan said, a dumpling held in the points of her chopsticks, "was it luxurious?"

Josh set his brandy down, saying, "It was awesome—way better than Air Canada."

Pop beamed, truly enjoying that she'd been gifted a weekend vacation to the Caribbean and flew in a private plane.

"It was a relief not to have the usual hassles," Kimmy said.

Eileen said, "I can't believe you're working for a guy from high school."

Eileen hadn't really known Devlin. Eileen was two grades below her and had been as bookish and detached from high school culture as Kimmy had been. If Eileen had known how crazy it was Kimmy was working for thee Devlin-fucking-Stone, she would be wielding that over Kimmy's head like a claymore. The best her uninformed sister could come up with was that Kimmy was employed by a peer. And the implication, of course, that were Devlin not a peer, Kimmy wouldn't have such a great-paying job that came with wonderful perks.

Josh must have seen the intended disparagement, saying, “They weren’t exactly friends in high school, that’s for sure.”

Eileen lifted her gaze to Josh, looking to soak up any info that might lessen the burden of Kimmy’s recent boon. Like she could get her crowbar in a crack and test for weakness, Eileen said, “I like the sound of this guy. Is he a millionaire?”

Josh’s good humor retreated.

Kimmy said, “I’m sure he is—”

Josh said, “It’s his dad’s company. Don’t you remember this guy? He was like Dalton’s biggest entitled jerk.”

“Not really,” Eileen said, and Kimmy could see the fire in Josh’s eyes. If Eileen had more questions about this interesting man of wealth and power, Josh was ready to dissuade her sister about how the guy deserved any measure of respect.

And, no, Devlin deserved little respect from Josh.

The guy was fucking Josh’s wife, and he didn’t know it. But that was on her.

Maybe it was all over, anyway.

No Devlin at all this week and she got the message loud and clear. Or at least she thought she did. She’d set a trap, and it had worked. Maybe.

Amy had said on the phone: You’ve got the bucks now. . . . How would Amy know what her salary was? Did it make sense that Amy could have appropriately speculated, or had Devlin told her how much he was paying her? . . .

Monday, Devlin didn’t show before lunch and she didn’t text him. Not until one o’clock. Devlin texted back he can’t make it. Okay, she’d thought. He didn’t come in Tuesday either. He texted her saying he had too much to do

out in Kingston and he'd come on Wednesday. Didn't come on Wednesday. Or Thursday, or today.

Had Amy passed Devlin a message?

Did Devlin hear from Amy how he wasn't really lighting up Kimmy's pinball machine? It wasn't likely he was offended. He knew it firsthand to be untrue. But had he recognized that Kimmy had told Amy a lie in order to detect the flow of information around here? That could be likely.

Though she would have expected Devlin to play along rather than shy away and confirm her suspicions.

What if he had got his fill? What if he'd achieved all he wanted with his sexy new long-legged lawyer?

Wouldn't that be good news?

Wouldn't it be good news that the sex between them would end, and she could get back to the process of living her life with her husband and making money so they could start their family?

If she was right, there was no good news, only bad news.

It could mean Devlin was ghosting her because Amy and Devlin were up to something, messing with her.

Where would that leave her? Would it put her job in jeopardy? Would it put her marriage in jeopardy?

The regret for machinating against Amy was surprising. It proved two undeniable things. One, she wanted the job with Devlin. Two, more surprisingly, she wanted more sex with Devlin.

But if she was being set up, how dangerous was this game?

She couldn't stop it now. If Devlin and Amy were up to something, she would have to finish it, leave it in a way that they'd be afraid to touch her.

And a big part of that would be breaking Josh. Breaking him with the very thing he craved.

While Josh helped Susan get the dessert ready and her Pop went to the bathroom, Eileen went outside to smoke a cigarette and Kimmy joined her on the balcony. It was almost eight o'clock, and the sun was descending, the night colors deepening and the shadows in the valley below her Pop's condo were growing long and dark.

Eileen plopped her cigarette pack on the balcony ledge, one unlit between her fingers already, lighter held loosely in her hand. She was looking really young and healthy, though still stern and judgmental, wearing her hair back and a touch of makeup. She was tall and lean, but not as tall as Kimmy.

Eileen watched her approach and her face took a more sympathetic ease. She said, "I know I wrote, and I called, but I was really sorry for you."

She nodded. The whole pregnancy thing seemed ages ago, though it'd been only this spring. Her summer spent as a basket-maker with an Etsy shop seemed like a book she read about someone else.

Eileen held out her arms, palms out, looking for a rare embrace. Kimmy took it, stepping close to her sister so the two of them could press their meager chests together and rub shoulder and backs. It was brief, but she did appreciate her sister's gesture.

When they parted, Eileen leaned on the ledge and lit her cigarette.

Kimmy said, "Where are you staying?"

"The usual. Here in town, the Marriott."

"Are you going to have time to come out and see us?"

"I have to see Robert's parent's lawyer. I have to go and visit his sister. I'm glad you could come out tonight. It's good to see you."

While they chatted about how Pop was doing and why he wouldn't admit that his friend Susan Araki was more than just a friend and why doesn't he present her like they're a couple before Susan is offended and moves on—Do you know how much cooking she does for him?—her mind couldn't get off the topic of Devlin's absence and what it might mean.

It came clearer to her in her sister's presence. Nothing made her more competitive—or made her feel more unfulfilled—than her sister's success. Devlin offered her the one thing she didn't know she desired, an irresistible temptation. Had Amy something to do with that? Amy would know—or at least think she knew—some of Kimmy's deepest unspoken secrets.

She said to Eileen, "How do you do it all?"

"All what?"

"You're busy. Dentist, business owner . . . What do you have time for?"

"What else is there?"

"Robert."

"Of course," Eileen said, shaking her head and narrowing her eyes, uncomprehending.

"And it's still, I don't know . . . good?"

Eileen thought about it, straightening, elbow on the ledge, wisps of smoke dancing off her cigarette. "Things aren't good with Josh?"

She shook her head now, also straightening, not wanting her sister to misunderstand. "Not at all. Things are great with Josh. I meant . . . I wondered how it was for you, if you were happy that way."

"Why wouldn't I be?"

"Of course you are," she said, sighing, joining her sister in leaning on the ledge. She looked over and straight down to the grass and the patios below;

a sandy trail wound along beside a rivulet and there were people down there, strolling together. What she wanted to know was hard to iterate.

Eileen said, “Is something going on with you and Josh? Are things all right after . . .”

Kimmy nodded without looking Eileen’s way. “It’s nothing like that, it’s . . . Do you ever feel like time is passing now? Like significant time, time we won’t get back?”

“No one gets any time back.”

“Not time. Experience.”

Now Eileen got it. At least clearer than she had before, her lips bowing as she nodded and ashed her cigarette.

“Forget I said anything,” Kimmy said.

They watched together out over the deepening evening and the orangey glow.

After Eileen tapped the cigarette for the tenth time without ever having taken a drag on it, Kimmy said, “What are you doing?”

Eileen held the cigarette up near the side of her face, one arm folded. “Standing out here with you.”

She nudged her chin at the cigarette. “Why aren’t you smoking that?”

Eileen offered it her way. “Do you want it?”

“I don’t smoke. You shouldn’t either.”

“I quit,” Eileen said, eyes aside, mouth scrunched to one side.

“I hate to be the one to break it to you . . .”

Eileen smiled a moment, then looked through the windows to see where everyone was. Josh was moving around at the table, clearing some of the dinner dishes to make room for whatever baking Susan had prepared.

Eileen said, “Don’t tell Pop, but . . .”

“But what? You’re not smok— Oh, you’re not saying . . .”

“I didn’t want to mention it to Pop—it’s so early, but, yeah, I’m pregnant.” Eileen let her hand brush over her stomach and then put it in the pocket of her skirt. The other hand tapped out the burned-down cigarette on the ledge, then put it in the lidded pot she’d been using since she got here.

There was a drop-away feeling, a weird nothing-under-her-feet see-saw feeling that made her unsteady—the height, the balcony, the world shifting; she got a queasy sense of sudden vertigo. Happiness popped up, but envy squeezed it. Hard enough like it wanted to squeeze out its life.

“You okay?” Eileen said.

What, because I lost my pregnancy, now you’ll have Pop’s first grand baby?

“I’m fine,” she said, much effort heaved into pushing out a convincing smile. “Can I hug you, or will that give it away?”

“You can hug me,” Eileen said.

They came together again and gave each other their awkward embrace. There were honest-to-goodness feelings of love—she was going to be a real Auntie!—but there was a greenish rise of brack-water jealousy that felt awful, yet she didn’t hate. It was the prompt of challenge, the feeling she could battle again. It had been a long time since she’d felt this aggressive streak; a long time since she felt so driven and alive.

In the passenger seat of the Qashqai on their way home, Josh said, “It was good seeing Eileen, huh? Wish it was more than once a year.

Maybe in the winter we can get out to Calgary and visit them. What do you think?"

"She's pregnant."

Josh's head whipped her way; he smiled wide. "She is? Really? She never said a thing."

"She told me. She's trying to keep it from Pop for now. It's early."

"That's smart," Josh agreed.

Yes, because of me. Because I hurt Pop by losing a baby before it was born and my sister made a point of letting me know she now had to protect our father's feelings from yet another of my screwups.

"She'll be fine."

"I bet. I wonder if it's going to be a boy or a girl."

"I don't think I really want to talk about it right now," she said.

Josh faced her while she drove and she felt bad for snapping. She put a hand on his thigh.

One hand on the steering wheel, she settled into the seat while Josh closed his eyes. It was an hour and a half from home. Her other hand moved into her lap. Then swept higher, rested on the flat of her own stomach. Today her period was eight days late.

IV

Saturday, August 22

Korean Fare

Things had been fine between them since they got back from Cayman, but it seemed like they'd both been too busy for each other. No bad words exchanged, but sometimes when it was quiet in his office, he'd wonder if Kimmy resented the things he'd encouraged her to do last weekend. That would make sense. What kind of wife would respect her husband harboring such strange counter-intuitive fantasies? Did Kimmy do it because they were both so turned on, but once she got back home to their apartment, started to consider how weird it had been?

From the bathroom now, she asked him, "What time is it?"

He could see her putting on eyeliner in the mirror through the half-open bathroom door as he lay on the bed with his iPad. He told her it was five-thirty.

Tonight she was going out for dinner with Hyun. A Girl's Night, because Kimmy hadn't had one in a long time.

"I better get moving," she said.

"You've got lots of time. She lives around the corner."

"I don't want to be late."

He said, "Now you've got your own Meyer like you wanted, you don't want to let her down." Kimmy had lamented to him she had no more confidantes, that her schedule conflicted with Karina's and that she wished she had someone to talk to. He'd asked her about what, and she'd said,

“The things I don’t want to tell you.” Then she’d laughed at his speechlessness.

“I’ve always liked Hyun,” she said, jabbing the eyeliner brush back in its sleeve.

“Yeah, Hyun’s cool,” he said, fingering through an iPad game where you had to shoot apples with a bow and arrow.

Kimmy appeared in the gap, leaning an arm on the doorjamb. “Why don’t you go hang out with Meyer and Sophie?”

“I told you, he’s going out to Kingston with her to visit my aunt and uncle.”

“What, you’re not welcome there?”

“I am, it just seems like a father-daughter thing.”

“You don’t want to be Uncle Third Wheel?”

“No. Why are you getting so dressed up to go out with Hyun?”

“I’m not getting dressed up. I’m not wearing anything yet.” All she wore was a baggy black tee-shirt, her long skinny legs bare below its hanging hem.

He said, “You’re putting on makeup.”

She laughed at him, disappearing inside the bathroom again, saying, “Lipstick and eyeliner, Josh, is hardly putting on makeup.”

It was closer to it than not putting on makeup. He could hear her slipping on her clothes behind the open door.

What the hell was wrong with him? He still couldn’t shake suspicious thoughts about Kimmy, even though they’d come so far since the weekend. Or at least he thought they did. The truth was, they hadn’t discussed a thing, and he’d worried she was having second thoughts about all the stuff he’d done with her. But this concern he had over her makeup had nothing to do

with Hyun and everything to do with Devlin Stone. A tantalizing suspicion his wife was only telling him she was going out with Hyun, using Hyun as a decoy so she could go have dinner with Devlin. That was the heart of his dark thoughts. It was so all-consuming he had to twist even a night out with their niece's mother as sexual.

It looked like this perversion was here to stay for a little while. Fuck, what if it was forever?

Now she appeared in the doorway wearing her outfit and he wasn't unconvinced she was going out to fuck Devlin. It was an outfit stylish enough and easy enough to remove should she end up hooking up with his high school bully in some hotel room here in Ajax. Kimmy getting a good, deep-dick fucking, then sliding home again with stories about Hyun she'd made up.

"You look great," he said, his cock throbbing and thickening. He raised his knees.

Kimmy looked beautiful in an oversized white sweater that hung off one shoulder; the sweater was short enough you could almost see her bare stomach. The skirt she wore was long and flowing, midnight blue, pleated, with a thin belt closed by a small gold buckle.

"With white sneakers. What do you think?"

"Amazing as usual." She'd really upgraded her wardrobe since working for Devlin. And he wondered if she wore panties and a bra.

But of course she had. Why couldn't these thoughts go away?

If this kink was here to stay for a while, he was going to have to convince his wife to re-engage with it. If he didn't, it was going to wreck him. Wreck him because he could not stop thinking about it. It was a sexual obsession ever since she'd experimented with it a little in Cayman. Now he was back, he looked to chase it away for Kimmy's sake, but the darn little gremlin wasn't afraid of him. It would only trot away a few steps, then linger and work its way back to whisper these kinky what-ifs in his ear.

As Kimmy disappeared into their closet looking for her shoes, he shoved away the iPad and got up, adjusting his pants. He'd got erect from those what-ifs.

He joined her at the closet door, Kimmy at the dresser, putting things in a small black purse. A new one, Chanel. She'd told him Devlin hadn't been to work all week, said he was out in Kingston. He had to believe her, but it seemed strange. Devlin had thought that Josh and Kimmy had been trying to engage him in a threesome, and that kind of thought in a guy like Devlin's head would have him sniffing around Kimmy's Toronto office on Monday morning no matter what pressing work called to him in Kingston.

What would keep him away?

Maybe he wasn't away. Maybe Kimmy was lying.

Lying because she was fucking him? Or maybe lying because she worried her husband was going to hound her feverishly about whether she could see Devlin's cock through his pants. Maybe she had come to her senses and wanted to avoid her husband's kink because it freaked her out.

Kimmy said, "So what are you going to do tonight? It's Saturday night."

He shrugged. "Order in. Play some video games. Watch a movie."

She avoided judging him, instead just snaking a hand around to scratch the nape of his neck while she kissed him. "Have fun," she said.

It wasn't the most exciting Saturday night he had planned, but he would have fun.

They walked together down the hall to the front door. She kissed him again, and he stood in the doorway as she walked down the hall to the elevators, that long skirt swishing around her legs. She waved as she stepped into the elevator. When she was gone, he closed the door and locked it.

Even though Kimmy was just going for dinner with Hyun, he was going to enjoy hanging around the apartment tonight, imagining she was out for a

secret tryst with Devlin Stone.



At first their meeting seemed awkward, but once Hyun had served dinner, Kimmy relaxed. Things didn't seem so stiff once they'd both finished their first glass of wine.

Originally, her night out with Hyun was supposed to be for the two of them to go see a movie, maybe go out for dinner. Two days after they made plans, Hyun had texted how she had a bunch to do on Saturday and maybe would be too tired to go out, and how about she made dinner, and they could relax and talk.

That had been fine with her. It'd be nice to relax outside of the house. It had been a very long time since she'd gone out with Karina. Their schedules conflicted. Plus, there was a certain guilt associated with Karina because Karina knew what happened at Tiffany's party and was keeping it from Josh as a favor to her. And even now, Karina thought Kimmy had told Josh what happened. And she did, but not all the way to the truth, her curling stone skating the length of ice to land six feet out from the bull's-eye, sitting on the outer blue ring.

So a night out with Hyun was perfect. Josh had his cronies. Guys he could talk to. What would he tell them? No way he would tell them about all his freaky predilections. But what would he tell them? Did he talk about their sex life? Probably. What would he say? What would she want him to say?

She and Hyun sat at the kitchen table in Hyun's apartment, and it was a pleasant set up. The lights had a dimmer and were set low, flickering flame light from a half dozen candles on the table. Hyun had made some spicy kimchi jjigae, served with jasmine rice, kimchi pickled eggs, and a light and vinegary dongchimi on the side, and she kept telling Hyun how amazing the

stew was. And it wasn't lip service. It really was maybe some of the best she'd ever had.

She wiped her mouth now and a little under her eyes. The spice was getting to her in the best way, and it had them both giggling.

Bowl empty, she sipped her wine and asked, "How's Sophie been doing?"

"Great, we went out this morning and got all her back-to-school things."

"What grade is she starting?"

"Three."

"I can't believe it."

"Me neither."

Hyun talked about how scary it was to send a child off to school, and then they shared info about their own first days of school. Kimmy made fun of her sister, saying how her sister was so frightened on the first day, she bawled and threw herself on the floor.

Hyun chuckled through her nose, then held a napkin over her mouth so she could keep laughing. She said, "Let's hope Sophie doesn't give me any trouble like that."

"Something tells me Sophie is going to love going back to school."

"I hope so," Hyun said, picking up a scrap of cabbage and popping it in her mouth.

"How's school going with you?"

"Good," Hyun said. "A lot of work, but two years from now, I hope to get out of night shifts. That's where I'm at right now, dreaming of a time I can work a nine-to-five."

Kimmy waited a beat, picked up a quarter slice of radish in her chopsticks, then waited for Hyun to look up so their eyes would meet.

She said, “What about your guy friend? How’s that going?” What was the point of having girlfriends if you couldn’t talk about guys?

Hyun look puzzled for a second, then caught on. “Oh, that. No, that’s . . . I think that’s over.”

“Oh, I’m sorry.”

Hyun shrugged and said, “No, it was me. My decision. I think I lost interest . . .”

Later on the couch, with the dishwasher running, the candles put out and new ones lit on the family room coffee table, they drank the wine she brought.

Hyun had something weighing on her. She would go to take a drink, then change her mind and rest the goblet in her lap.

They sat close together on the sofa, and at last Kimmy said, “What is it?”

Hyun looked caught. Her mouth paused open a moment. Then it closed, and her brow furrowed. She sipped her wine and set it down on the coffee table and pulled back her hair—still styled the way Kimmy had done it for her a few weeks ago. Then she let it down and stared off at a point on the floor a dozen feet out. “Earlier you said . . . You asked about my guy friend at school.”

“Yeah?”

“It’s not a guy.” Hyun didn’t look up, eyes still lowered to the floor. She leaned forward, collected her glass and held it in her lap again, swirled it nervously, the wine spinning in the glass’s bowl.

It seemed so obvious, but it took two or three seconds for it to sink in. At last, Kimmy said, “Oh, ho . . . Okay.”

“I haven’t told anybody that I know.”

“You haven’t told anyone?”

“Yeah,” she said, smirking and rolling her eyes up to the ceiling.

“Really? I’m the first one you told?”

“Obviously some people know,” she said, indicating women Hyun had been with.

“Oh,” Kimmy said again now, voice lower, her understanding of the whole thing deepening. “Does Meyer know?”

Hyun didn’t answer, but shook her head.

“Is that what happened between you two?”

Hyun looked up, but not at Kimmy, off to the side. “Meyer didn’t think I was . . . passionate.”

“And you weren’t passionate because . . .”

She shrugged her shoulders. “I don’t know. I guess it had something to do with it. But . . . It’s not as though I didn’t like Meyer. I loved Meyer. I guess I still do in a way.”

“And he still doesn’t know?”

Hyun looked exasperated—not at Kimmy, like at the situation—and sagged into the couch’s corner and looked up at the ceiling again. She said, “Meyer thought I was having an affair.”

“He did?”

“You hadn’t heard that before?”

Kimmy said no.

“I wondered if he told Josh.”

“If Meyer told Josh, Josh would’ve told me.”

“Not that it matters, anyway, I guess,” Hyun said, and took a long drink of wine.

Kimmy drank as well, her heart rate picking up a little. Josh had Meyer and Steve to confide in. People he could look to for advice and angles in situations that affected him. She had no one. Only Josh. There were things she couldn’t tell Karina. She wouldn’t talk to her sister, she couldn’t trust Amy. . . . Who else did she have? And she needed someone.

“You can tell me about it,” she said.

Hyun chewed the inside of her cheek for a second, put her wineglass on the coffee table. She sat upright again, tying her hair behind her head. She folded her arms and lay back in the corner. She said, “I didn’t really have an affair.”

“But kind of an affair?” She smiled, making it sly, wanting Hyun to know she could have a confidant. Kimmy would be Hyun’s confidant, because she wanted Hyun to be one for her as well.

“It was . . . I don’t know, I guess you’d call it, like, from here,” she said, tapping between her breasts with her two middle fingers, then re-folding her arms. She wore no bra under her white three-button top, and in the light cast from the candles, Kimmy could see her nipples. It felt very tragic and yet inspiring. Hyun was beautiful. She had perfect skin, a cherub’s face, and the most beautiful eyes. The way she sat, with her bare legs and feet under her, made her look young and innocent. Hyun was troubled by her own actions. Kimmy was troubled by her own actions. They were two of the same, though their circumstances differed.

“You can tell me,” she said again, wanting to be a source of comfort for Hyun.

Hyun looked her way, still chewing her cheek. She said, “I think I fell in love with someone. A woman . . .”

“But nothing ever happened?”

“Nothing ever happened,” Hyun said. “This woman doesn’t even know.”

“But once you and Meyer divorced, you didn’t pursue her?”

“I don’t think she feels the same. Plus, she’s with someone.”

“A man?”

Hyun nodded.

“Oh,” Kimmy said. “That’s too bad.”

“I know it is,” Hyun said. “But anyway, nothing ever happened.”

Kimmy sipped her wine, contemplating if she could ever divulge her own misdeeds. Her own affair. Hers not of the heart at all, but lower and baser. Dirtier.

“Nothing ever happened,” Hyun said. “But I wanted it to.”

“Even though she was with someone?”

“I wouldn’t have told,” Hyun said.

V

Sunday, August 23

Sunday Mornings

In the Sunday morning sunlight, she woke up horny. Josh still lay asleep in bed next to her.

It had been a full week without sex. No sex at all. The first Monday back, she'd expected to meet Devlin at his apartment near the office, like they'd arranged. When Devlin didn't show up to work at all, it was easy enough to shuffle thoughts of sex to the back of her mind. If Devlin was trying to control her by making her wait—hoping to build a desire in her, or perhaps to make her feel foolish—she wouldn't fall into his trap, she would disregard him. In fact, sex with Devlin behind Josh's back in Cayman had done a number on her. By Tuesday, the tight ache in her backside became a throbbing that bothered her when she walked. More sex with Devlin probably wasn't a good idea, anyway. A break was a good idea. Good thing Devlin was lying low.

And sex with Josh never happened, either. Just wasn't in the cards. Their schedules didn't cooperate (though they'd always found time in the past, even when they were both very busy), and Josh didn't pursue it with her.

She surmised why: embarrassment.

The things Josh asked for and confided were pretty big for a man to introduce to his wife, even if he had skirted around it for a long time. Was he afraid to broach it again? Was he afraid to initiate sex in case it reminded his wife of the weird things she learned this last weekend that turned him on? Or, wilder yet, did Josh want more but was fearful to request it because she'd told him she would entertain his kink for one time only? That had been her plan, and she'd hate to think it would be so easy. And yet, laying

here, wanting sex, even regular sex with her husband whom she loved, she could convince herself Josh's hesitation was due to her manipulation. And, fuck, if that didn't turn her on like crazy.

She rolled to her side to watch her husband sleep.

His back was to her, and he was peaceful. He wore the Hell tee-shirt he'd bought in Cayman. Cayman must have splendid memories for him. Which was counter-intuitive since his high school bully showed up to dominate his wife's time. And yet, Josh made the best of it. They both had.

The warmth of love seeped through her. The weekend had been fun. There were special times there. Times of closeness with Josh. The sex with Devlin was just sex with Devlin. It would be crazy to disregard the closeness she'd enjoyed with the guy she fell in love with in college and who she married. One of the most positive influences in her life.

Making fun of Devlin with Josh, defusing Devlin's masculine dominance over other guys like Josh, had been an enjoyable enterprise. A thing they did together and giggled about in hushed tones behind Devlin's back. She'd enjoyed it.

She owned the best of both worlds. A husband who loved her and whom she loved, one she played around with and shared the most important things, secret things, and she also had Devlin. A powerful and masculine man who was sexy and who annihilated her in bed. She'd done terrible things with Devlin, but there was a narrow space for her to aim into, one where she could bring both those worlds closer together and not have to have them exist in complete independence. The survival of her relationship with Josh depended on it. And that was the only relationship worth a damn.

She wormed against his back, spooning him, and slipped an arm around to lay her hand on his chest. Josh stirred.

Her greatest desire: A day where her lies weren't so confounding and compounding and where the things she said didn't have to be measured against to whom she said them. To live in truth rather than in lies.

An overwhelming regret weighed on her with sudden, surprising volume. The things she'd done could never be undone. She wished that they never came to be.

But if she forced Josh too hard into his own kink, she risked discovery. It would be better for Josh if she took her time, no matter how uncomfortable her lies were becoming.

Josh stirred, sensing her touch on his body. She strummed her nails on his tummy like playing a guitar, studying his face, smiling, and waiting for him to wake up. He was slow to wake. Sound asleep. She reached lower and with her thumb and forefinger knuckle honked his package underneath his pajama pants. She needed it now, thumbing and squeezing.

What she'd honked turned out to be the head of his penis. Even if when Devlin was flaccid and sleepy, she wouldn't be able to nip the end of his cock like that.

Her hand slipped under Josh's waistband, and he groaned. She choked a finger-and-thumb grip on his penis and milked it downward, letting him know she wanted it hard.

While her mind focused on Josh, she'd put in her head the comparison between the two of them: Josh and Devlin. And it was funny how two guys' genitalia differed. Josh's cute and normal little guy versus that strange swinging club of man-flesh the Devlin sported. And yes, it was better. Bigger was better. That didn't make what Josh sported any less. What Devlin had was better than what Josh had, but it was also better than what 98% of men in the world out there had. Heck, she'd even venture 99%. But she was no expert.

She blurted a raspberry on Josh's shoulder, hoping the loudness would disconnect her thoughts from Devlin. This was Josh's time. Then again, Josh's time these days was also Devlin's time. It's what Josh wanted.

A sleepy groan now from Josh, eyelashes fluttering. Awake, yet still not awake. She kissed his shoulder, then decided to be annoying. She let his

dick go and hugged him, digging the point of her chin in that sensitive spot between his neck and shoulder. It got him flinching and complaining.

He groaned, “What are you doing?”

She said, “What are you doing?”



Josh’s eyes fluttered open, taking in the bedroom, breathing deep, coming out of an amazing ten-hour sleep. He felt incredible. He shifted his head aside to see Kimmy looming close and large over his shoulder.

He said, “What are you doing?”

She answered, “What are you doing?”

He squinted and chuckled.

“Are you awake yet?”

“I think so,” he said, shifting to lie on his back.

Kimmy scooted her body to eclipse his, chest to chest, then straddling his hips. She sat back, her crotch pressing against his hardening member. Kimmy was horny. This was going to be an exceptional day.

He stroked his hands up her thighs, smiling as she loomed over top of him. She pouted. “Have you lost interest in me?”

“What do you think?” He humped his hips so she would feel his erection between her legs.

“We haven’t had sex all week.”

“It’s a real shame,” he said, getting into the dirty talk rather than being pragmatic.

“It’s not totally crazy that we didn’t have sex for a week, but—”

“What, did it hurt your feelings?” He could be macho, too, smiling at her and showing her a confident expression. He could take ownership of his feelings and his jealousy and his lust.

“I feel so left out,” she said, and pouted.

He laughed and said, “How was your night with Hyun?”

Kimmy humped against him, gyrating her sex into his hardness. “It was neat.”

“Neat?”

“Fun,” she said. “We had fun.”

“What did you guys do?”

“Just talked.”

“That’s all you did? Talk?”

“We’re girls, Josh. We don’t need to sit in front of a TV and pretend to shoot terrorists or chase vigilantes across the wild West.”

“What did you talk about, 13th century medieval literature?”

“Boys,” she said, looking cute and raising her eyebrows.

His laugh got her bouncing on him. “And here I thought you two were a couple of intellectuals.”

He lay his hands up on the pillow, encouraging Kimmy to take them. She did, leaning right over top of him, putting her fingers between his. In the

second before she leaned over him, he'd seen her budding nipples through her tank top. He was hard as a rock now.

She kissed his neck, whispered, "What did you do without me last night?"

He'd had dreams of staying up all night playing video games. But instead of ordering a pizza and flopping down on the couch, he'd gone out for a long walk, ate a turkey sandwich at Subway, came back, lay on the couch and fell asleep watching a movie. Sometime around eleven, he went to bed. Kimmy hadn't been home then, and he didn't know what time she got in.

"Totally nothing. It was great."

"No video games?"

"It was nice out. I went for a walk."

She stopped kissing him for a second, reared her head back to show him a comically befuddled face.

"I'm serious."

"Okay. Are you going to go vegan on me?"

"You'd like that, wouldn't you?"

She said, "I'm a vegan. Kind of. But I like men to be men."

"So vegan is off the list."

"Off the list," she said, and kissed his neck again.

"And what about knitting?"

"Nope," she said.

"And video games?"

"Lame," she said.

Josh laughed, but that one stung a little. Is that what Kimmy thought? When he had all his buddies over here and they hung out together, it felt so natural and right. Did she not like that? She never said anything about it before.

His hands slipped from under her so he could stroke the narrowness of her waist. She was so lean and so sexy. It drove him wild how she seemed to be realizing it too. The messiness that he'd known her for had gone. She was sleek, sophisticated, elite. And almost mean.

Telling him she didn't really like video games.

It hit him: Was this dirty talk? Was Kimmy playing along?

His heart raced at the idea that maybe Kimmy changed her mind on the One Night Only thing. Maybe she'd still like to play the game, even when they weren't in Cayman. But how would he broach it? He didn't want to make her mad. Or disappoint her. How would he know if she were open to it?

He rubbed her back, sought her lips. They made out together, his wife over top of him, pumping her pussy against the belly of his hard cock, and giving him her tongue. She was so exquisite, such an amazing thing to have in his life. Fuck, if she said no more video games, he'd do it.

Maybe that was an angle.

"I'll give up video games if you tell me dirty stuff," he winked and chuckled and squeezed her tight.

And Kimmy laughed too, not even knowing the weird things that were going through his head. She asked him what was so funny, even through her own laughter.

"Nothing is funny," he said, dead serious, looking into her eyes. "I love you."

"I love you too," she said, and chased after him with her kiss, taking his mouth again.

Well, shit, horny Kimmy would be about the best Kimmy to test out a willingness to engage in dirty talk games again. He began to work her tank top up her back, and she was eager to get it off, raising over him to squash her butt down on his dick, taking the top off and flinging it to the floor, making her little breasts bounce. She was playful today. She turned him on like crazy. He tickled her tummy because he couldn't resist. Maybe that wasn't a manly thing to do, but he fucking wanted to. Didn't men do what they wanted?

Kimmy jolted and laughed, crushed his waist with scissoring thighs. "Don't," she said, still laughing.

He rolled her onto her side so they were face-to-face, his hand slipping down her side, under her panties, and pushing them down. Her long legs worked with him, wiggling until they were off. He sat up and pulled off his T-shirt, flung it away as well. She latched onto his nipple and when he yelped, she bit it.

"Ow," he complained, but didn't pull away. Something about the odd pain was exciting. He explored it, grimacing, baring his teeth to the ceiling but stroking the back of her head. Kimmy bit his nipple harder. "Ow!" She giggled, blew another raspberry on his chest, and it got him falling back, tucking his hands under his armpits, forming an X over his chest to protect his sensitive nipples from his kinky wife.

"How would you like it?" he said coldly and scowling.

She sat on a hip next to him, one hand on the mattress so her shoulder poked high with her cheek rested on it. The other hand stroked a breast, squeezed her own nipple. She said, "I don't know. Do we want to find out?"

"You're really horny."

She chuckled and hid her face, but admitted: "I'm really horny."

"A whole week without me."

Coquettish: "We had a lot of fun last weekend."

He saw an opening, but was afraid to take it. There was a long beat of silence, and then he said it, anyway.

“And Devlin didn’t come to work this week either.”

It flopped.

Kimmy showed no expression, still regarding him, still with one hand cupped on her little breast and squeezing her own nipple.

It was so uncomfortable. The word Sorry formed on his tongue, but he was even afraid to say that now.

She said, “Is that why you think I’m horny?”

“No.”

Kimmy smiled a little, and he relaxed, feeling like it was water under the bridge. Her eyes moved from his, down his body to where his erection poked up his pajama pants. She tugged the fabric until the tip of his bare dick poked out of the fly. Just an inch end of what he had, rock hard and ready for action. She snugged the fabric down tighter, making it stick right out. His heart beat pounded in his chest, looking down and wondering if Kimmy thought of what Devlin’s would look like sticking out of his pajama pants.

Would she even do that with Devlin? He wouldn’t even be playful. Just get her on her back and pound into Kimmy’s guts.

A glistening bead of pre-come formed in the cup of Josh’s urethra. Kimmy saw it, touched her index finger to it and sent shivering electricity all through him by circling her finger all over the edges of his cock head. He groaned, tightened his whole body, sent out more pre-come. Kimmy’s touch had him writhing.

With his eyes closed, the unexpected warm liquid-velvet sensation of Kimmy’s mouth on his cock got him hissing inward a gulp of air. He tucked his chin down to see his beautiful wife sucking on his cock. Her head

worked up and down lovingly, her cheeks hollowed, bringing wonderful pressure, and her slithering tongue doing incredible things.

What a Sunday morning.

Anatomy

Josh relaxed, sinking into the bed and focusing on what she did. Kimmy took her time, soft and slow, and so loving. So caring. It went on until he thought he couldn't take it, and a worry began. If he came in her mouth, would she be disappointed? She would have to wait for him to get hard again, and if she was horny, then she needed something. He had to warn her.

“Kimmy . . . I need you.”

She liked that, her mouth drawing up the length of his cock, backhanding her shiny lips and smiling. She hiked a leg over top of him again and straddled his hips. Only this time, she was naked. And this time, his cock was sticking out of his pajamas. Their sexes touched and a storm of phosphorescent fireworks went off in front of his hazy, unseeing eyes. Their connection was beautiful. It felt incredible. He dipped his butt, tilted his pelvis, and without using any hands, they angled themselves perfectly for him to slip inside her. Kimmy let out a small gasp, lowered herself, cupping his neck, scratching his jawline, and kissing him. She was wet and eager. He passed into her with no restriction. No moment where they had to realign or re-lubricate. Just right inside her, all the way, no hesitation, only liquid ease. His hands cupped her bottom, and pushed down with each stroke, his hips pushing up. With his pajama pants still on, he worried he wouldn't be deep enough inside her; that he would slip out easily. So he worked hard to get in her deeply and prevent her from humping so vigorously he popped out. He wanted the pajama pants off.

But they fucked with his PJ pants on. They fucked, and he tried to push it out of his head. Kissing her, taking her tongue.

At last he gasped, "I want on top."

Kimmy said, "I want on top," and humped down hard. She sat back, squashed down on his cock. He tugged on the pajama pants, trying to free more shaft. The front fly of his pajamas was soaked wet from their union. Her saliva, her own lubrication. He said, "I have to get these pants off."

Kimmy smiled, swiveling her hips. She had total control. She said, "There's no time, Josh, I just need dick."

He said, "Yeah, but it's my dick. I want it all the way out."

Kimmy said, "Why do you want all the way out?" She fell over top of him again.

This was it. Right? This was the game. Or maybe it wasn't?

He struggled to answer, wanting to say the right thing, but knowing it would be the wrong thing.

He hesitated, then said, "I guess you need every inch I've got right now."

Kimmy uttered a purring appreciative sound. "I guess you're right."

"Kimmy doesn't need to be shortchanged," he said, looking into her eyes and stroking hair back from her face.

She played along. "I deserve all the inches," she said, then giggled.

"Every single one of them."

Now his heart absolutely pounded. This was it. It was really happening. Kimmy was playing along and they weren't even in Grand Cayman. He thumbed down his waistband, and Kimmy eased herself up. Just when he thought his dick would fall free, she shoved herself back down hard, stabbing his cock deep inside again. The pleasure was exquisite. He moaned, his stomach tightened. Kimmy laughed, enjoying the joke.

"Oh my God," he said, reeling, with nothing more to say.

Kimmy pulled up again, raising on her knees and elbows, her face moving from his chin to his forehead, and just when his cock was about to fall out she did it again, squashed back down. Only this time she'd gone too close to the fire. It didn't work. His dick popped out and when she squashed back, it scooted between them.

She blurted out with laughter at the failure, and he hugged her. "Nice try," he said.

"I guess I do need a longer dick."

Any other time had she said something like that, his feelings would've been so hurt he would've had to excuse himself from the situation. But for some reason, it had been what he was waiting to hear. And this time there was no hurt. There was, but it felt so fucking good.

Josh chuckled with her, said, "It would be just fine if you weren't monkeying around like that."

"I'm just being playful, I can't help it if it slipped out."

"Because that's my fault?"

Kimmy raised over him so they could look at each other. Her expression was amused but still tentative. He smirked, showing his feelings weren't hurt. She sucked on her lower lip for a second, then let it go. She was playing along. She wasn't 100% in, but she was playing the game for his sake. He wouldn't push it. It was too much of a gift, even this small slice. It would be rude to ask for more. He would have to encourage her, show her how he liked it.

"Stay there," he said. Kimmy stayed where she was, and her smile grew. He reached between them, pushed down on his dick, and tickled at her labia. She responded by shifting her hips from side to side. "Hold on," he said again, pushed his pajama pants down, got them past his upper thighs and that was good enough. Then he thumbed forward his dick so she could sit down on it again. She sank back, taking him all the way in, and he could feel the inch-and-a-half deeper he went inside her. Kimmy felt it too, raising

her eyebrows and looking at him sleepily and smiling. He said, “Isn’t that better?”

“I guess you’re right,” she answered, licking her lips, then sitting back on him, getting everything he had inside her. Not content for that to be enough, Kimmy’s hands went behind her and her nails tickled at his thighs. Her hands rested on his thighs and she walked her torso backward, stomach bowing outward, showing off her ribs and how flat her belly was. It put more pressure on their sexual union.

“Oh wow,” he said.

“Kama Sutra,” Kimmy sighed, and they both chuckled. He watched her ribs press against her skin with her laughter. Stroked a hand on her stomach.

“You feel so good,” she moaned.

“And you wanted to do it with my pajama pants on,” he said.

“Turns out I like it deep.”

“I’ve always known that about you,” he said.

Kimmy slapped at his hand laying on her stomach. They both laughed. She enjoyed the pleasure longer, her hands walking back farther to grip his knees, thumbs on the inside. She was bowed uncomfortably, but she definitely liked it. No thrusting, just feeling him deep. He watched her breathe, watched her beautiful body and the angle of her neck as she looked at the ceiling. She said, “Amy said Devlin touched her stomach.”

Josh’s eyes bulged and his neck swelled. Was she really going to do this?

But now all the thought of luring his wife into this kind of talk was dashed away. All lucid reasoning was gone. It was like he’d been walking on the edge of the Grand Canyon, thinking what it would be like to climb down, or parasail, and the next thing he knew, he’d stumbled and was falling. Right into the deadly danger. Panic, lust, and jealousy gushed in his mind like an out-of-control firehose, lashing this way and that. In that second, there were

many things that could've happened. He could have tossed Kimmy off him, stormed out; could've howled at her in a jealous rage; could have become a lusty freak and ask what Amy said about Devlin's huge cock. Somehow he was like a fighter pilot doing seven-Gs, consciousness fading, going into a barrel, facing death and disaster but somehow finding enough oxygen in his brain to get his hands back on the stick. If he wanted to get his desires from his wife, he would have to entertain the aspect that aroused her.

Though his hand was shaking, he touched where they were connected, ran his middle finger and ring finger up from her commissure toward her navel, stopping just short of six inches and then running a small purposeful circle there. About as deep as his cock would go. He looked at the distance from his fingers to her navel and wondered if Amy really would have felt Devlin in her stomach. Where was the stomach?

Now he took just the middle finger and stroked it upward, with sinking pressure, to Kimmy's flat stomach, coming up to her navel then saying, "Where's your stomach?"

Kimmy chuckled, walked her hands forward, then came to a sitting position again. Her cheeks were flushed. She sucked in her stomach again and looked down at where he touched her. She pressed graceful fingers from her ribs down to her navel. "I don't know," she said.

"Like, here?" He pressed into her belly button.

She chuckled, said, "I don't know. Where is your stomach?"

Josh reached to the side table but couldn't get to his phone. Kimmy leaned forward and was able to get to the table, but his dick slipped out of her. They both laughed at that. She got over top of him again, one hand angling his dick so she could sit with it inside her, the other hand bringing her phone to life. She passed it to him and said, "Find out where your stomach is."

While he did, Kimmy slowly gyrated on his cock. On the phone, Josh looked up woman's stomach anatomy, and went to images. "I don't know," he said, pretty doubtful that Devlin touched Amy's stomach. "It's

impossible, Kimmy. Intestines, maybe, bowel. Your stomach is way up here.” He touched the edge of her ribcage.

“Whatever it was,” Kimmy said, laughing, “Amy told me it was crazy how deep it felt.”

Josh, comically surly: “What does she know?”

Kimmy laughed harder, took her phone from him, and tossed it aside. It looked like all the dirty talk was over, Kimmy taking his hands again, getting a good stroking rhythm going, him with his hips held rigid and her working herself up and down on his cock that would never make a woman think he’d touched her stomach. Just a regular old cock.

He could beg for more, but this would be played as a long con. He’d have to play this out properly to get what he wanted without scaring the timid rabbit away from his trap. He chuckled again, thinking of his sly wife as a timid rabbit. Kimmy could probably trick the hunter into his own trap.

“What are you laughing at?” she asked him.

“Nothing,” he said, “this is just the best way to wake up on a Sunday morning.”

“Not too bad at all,” she said, throaty, getting close to where she wanted to be.

Josh stroked his hand on the small of her back and between her butt cheeks. And went for it.

He curled his index finger, doing it boldly the way a guy like Devlin might do, pushing until he found a weakness, getting the first knuckle and half of his middle finger into her back hole. Kimmy gulped and stayed still. She whispered a shocked sound—but was not at all put off.

With his finger there, he held her steady and began to take control. Began to fuck her rather than being the rigid, immobile fuck stick, holding her pussy in place with his finger up her butt and his cock going in and out of her. She

really liked it, her head turned to the side like she was doing a breaststroke, eyes closed, mouth hanging open. She really liked it.

He watched her face, watched it contort, but still stay in that passionate purgatory, loving the fuck out of what her husband was doing to her.

When she came, his heart erupted like Rocky at the top of the stairs in Philadelphia, jumping with its hands overhead. Kimmy laughed while she orgasmed. As his finger popped out of her butt, she fell to her side. “What the hell was that, Josh?”

“You tell me,” he said, smiling, dreamy, looking into her dark eyes.

“I think you’re kinkier than you even know, Josh. I think I’m pretty kinky, too. I didn’t know either.”

“Well, what are we going to do about it?”

Propositions

Kimmy considered something, a sly look on her face, eyes off to the side. She regarded him. “What would that look like?”

“What would what look like?”

“If we were going to be kinky.”

He corrected her. “Kinkier.”

They both laughed, squinting and cocking their heads like they were sizing up one another.

“Okay, kinkier,” Kimmy agreed. “What would it look like?”

“What does it look like to you? You’re the one saying we’re going to be kinky.”

“Kinkier.”

“Yes, kinkier.”

“So, you’re saying it’s up to me to decide?”

He cupped her cheek and thumb-stroked her chin. “It’s for both of us to decide.”

Kimmy leaned her head against his palm. “Don’t be shy, okay? You can tell me. You can trust me. I want to do this. . . . But not too far, right? I want to turn you on, but I don’t want to involve Devlin too much. He is my boss.”

“Agreed,” he said.

Kimmy kissed the heel of his thumb. “Let’s talk about it then. What can we do?”

“I don’t even know what to say.”

“You had lots to say in Cayman.”

“You told me to keep it there.”

“I know.”

Was it enough? Was Cayman enough, or did he want more? No—he wanted more. That was for sure. Should they go for more? That was the real question.

Kimmy said, “What about Hyun?”

“What about her?”

“Me and Hyun, a little girl-on-girl, would that turn you on?”

He broke out in an explosive laugh, head going back into the pillows. Kimmy cackled along with him, snuggling up against him.

“Seriously, Josh. What do you want?”

He stroked a hand on her back. “Why the hell would you bring Hyun into this?” He could barely utter the question intelligibly, still chuckling too hard.

“What, guys don’t like that?”

“No.” He was adamant. Then: “I mean, not like never. I . . . I never thought of that. Not Hyun. What’s wrong with you?”

“You only think of me with guys?”

“I don’t think of that either. I just . . .”

“Only Devlin?”

“No, that’s not it. I don’t know.”

“Find your words, baby,” she said, and patted his cheek.

“I can’t even put it into words, Kimmy. Really, I can’t.”

“Yeah, you can. You’re afraid to.”

“Is that what you think?”

“That’s what I know. You’re running from what you want—”

“Hey, Kimmy . . . I’m not running.”

“Maybe you’re afraid of it, or maybe you’re afraid I’ll be afraid of it. I think you don’t like the things you want. We can stop, Josh.”

He hadn’t anticipated the psychiatric evaluation. And he didn’t like it. But he didn’t like it because she was fucking hitting the bullseye, wasn’t she?

“I just don’t know, Kimmy.”

“We had fun in Cayman. I know you want to be kinky—kinkier—but we can stop or we can keep going. I’m willing to do either one, and if you want to keep going, I want to make it safe. We can travel at 40k an hour, seatbelts on and crash helmets. You don’t have to tell me what you want. I’m not pushing. But I know up here”—she tapped his temple—“there’s a whole battle being waged. I’m telling you what you want to know: I’m up for it. To some extent. When you’re ready, I’ll be here and ready too. You have to ask yourself some questions and I want you to be dead honest with yourself. When you’re ready, you let me know.”

“Like right now?”

“No, not right now.” She chuckled. “But don’t take forever. I think everything’s lined up right now and if it becomes misaligned, I’m not sure if this is the kind of thing that can endure. I don’t want to be a jerk, but, you know, like, this is a lot and I’m into it, but it’s not my thing. I’m doing this for you. If you don’t really want to do it, then we shouldn’t.”

“Do what?”

“Josh, I don’t know. That’s why I’m asking you.”

Fuck. What did she mean? Would she do something with Devlin? Did he want that? No. Did she want it? Was she using his kink to trick him into her sleeping with Devlin? No, that wasn’t true either. She already said she didn’t want to go too far. Already said don’t forget Devlin’s my boss. She didn’t want to do anything that would jeopardize this new job that she enjoyed. But then again, Devlin would fuck her in a heartbeat if she winked at him. Devlin would like her more as an employee if he got to fuck her. But Kimmy wouldn’t like that. And Kimmy would definitely think that would jeopardize her job.

He growled and thumped a fist on the bed.

“Hey,” Kimmy said. “What the hell’s going on with you?”

“I don’t even know, Kimmy. I don’t know what I want.”

Kimmy had no more to say and lay her cheek on his shoulder like they would sleep-in a little this way. Her breath felt nice on his skin.

What kind of man doesn’t know all the kinky shit he wants to do with his woman when she says let’s do kinky shit? Why was he so embarrassed to ask for the things he wanted? Stupid question. Because it was too weird. And because he worried it wasn’t even his idea. Worried it was Devlin’s idea implanted into his bourbon-hazed mind. Also worried the kink he’d been secretly entertaining was not something you could walk away from once you tried it. It changed things. It’s not like his kink was toys and whips and leather and spanking paddles. The only regret after using those things

and not liking it was the waste of money. His kinks weren't products you could return to the store.

No, Kimmy knew some of the truth and it was he who was afraid of more. Afraid that there was more.

The things they did in Cayman were a tease. They were exhilarating things, wild and provocative. But he'd be crazy to think they weren't a prelude to further kink. And that ultimate thing, the kink's end point was Kimmy sleeping with Devlin.

That was a fucking no-go. No fucking way. Even caressing the outer rim of that poisonous idea filled his blood with its rotten tang, turned his stomach sour, and made him mad. He shook his head on the pillow, his mood flipping one-eighty.

Kimmy whispered, "What?"

"What do you think Devlin thought," he said, "you and I having sex while he was there?"

She shrugged. "Tell me what you're thinking."

"You made sex noises he could hear."

"So?"

"Isn't it weird he might know what you sound like when you have sex? He's your boss."

She reared her head back to study him through narrowed eyes. "I did that for you."

"I'm not mad."

She lay her head back down. "You better not be. Of course I know that's weird. How do you think I feel?"

"Okay, okay."

“I did that so Devlin knows who my man is. I did that to make you feel good. To make sure your nemesis knows I get it good.”

“Get it good?”

She looked up again, smiling now. “You give it to me good, Josh,” she said, slinking against him, eyes narrowed to sultry slits. He rolled to his back, and she got chest to chest with him, face over his.

“I do. I know I do.”

“And I also did it to turn you on. Letting Devlin know what I sound like when I’m getting it good was for you. Not for Devlin. I don’t know what works for you and what doesn’t. I was pretty sure that would work for you. Devlin knows my sex sounds.”

“Look at you. Look at how bold you are. You’re so . . . confident now. I love it.”

“I think I love it, too. Do you think he’s thought about that sound since then?”

“Maybe.”

“Maybe?” She pouted in comical disappointment.

“Probably why he’s afraid to show up to work this week. Afraid he’ll pop a rod when he sees you.”

“That’d be something.”

The way she said it made him think of Kimmy desiring to see Devlin’s arousal. And despite that noxious stream of anger in his blood, he grew hard.

Kimmy detected his erection, then lay the inside of her thigh over it, the two of them laying in bed now like that famous picture of John Lennon and Yoko Ono—but he was Yoko.

“Maybe it’s the battle in your head that turns you on,” Kimmy said.

He chuckled. Then the more he thought of it, the longer his chuckle lasted, Kimmy’s knee bouncing on his belly with his laughter. It got her chuckling too, and she hugged his head.

“What’s so funny.”

“That’s it,” he said, and a certain elation lifted his spirit. “I think that’s it, Kimmy. I like the torture.”

“Ah,” she said, “the birth of every super villain in those movies you watch.”

“How the hell did I become the bad guy? I’m the hero.”

“You’re my hero,” she said and bit his earlobe.

He wriggled away and got on his side, the two of them face to face.

Kimmy said, “Well, then: What do you want me to do?”

“I guess torture me,” he said.

She patted his cheek harder and harder till he had to squint. Then she smoothed her palm on his neck. “I don’t want to torture you, Josh. I want to —”

He opened his eyes, saw Kimmy had an idea. “What?”

She bit her lower lip, hesitating, then said, “What if I talk about what I saw?”

He frowned. “What did you see?”

She made a face. “You know . . .”

“His . . .? Talk to him about it?”

Kimmy nodded, expression serious. Then the thought of what they were saying brightened a stupid smile on her face. She chuckled and hid away from him.

He shoved his hand between her and the bedding to make her look his way again. Kimmy's cheeks had gone rosy. "Tell me what you're saying."

"Why?" she studied his face and seemed to make a judgment on what he thought. "You like that idea?"

He was frozen for a moment. "Yeah, I think I do. Is that okay? Can you do that?"

"He's the one who got undressed in front of me. How should I bring it up? What do you want me to say?"

"You tell me how you'd do it."

Kimmy's eyes shifted aside, devious. He loved the little smile on her perfect lips. Loved that the two of them could together conspire something so weird and dirty that was just for them. He'd never felt closer to her. All his shields were lowering and the more receptive she became, the safer he felt despite the raw exposure. His cock pounded between his legs at full hardness again. When Kimmy saw it, she laughed and put her hand around it. Didn't jerk, just held it while she imagined how she would bring up to Devlin she'd seen his huge penis. Would she tell Devlin she liked it? Fuck, the idea got him throbbing in his wife's grip.

Kimmy noticed, chuckled, and stroked. "Okay, I think we're on the right track. Kind of a shaky start but it looks like we got your motor running."

"I hate that I like this. That's the secret," he admitted.

"Okay," Kimmy said. "I can work with that."

Bait

Now she had something to work with.

It was hard to believe how it had all progressed. Hard to imagine that what Devlin said about Josh could be true. And Josh's truth was a path to her own salvation.

His cock throbbed in her hand, stiff and hot as a curling iron. She worked her grip up and down in slow drags, watching her husband sink into the bed, face showing heavenly bliss in combat with angst. The path was like a long stretch of traffic and all ahead were green lights. It seemed so clear, and her control of the situation strengthened. Her control was as sure as the grip on Josh's cock. Somehow, she could bring him happiness amidst all this badness. It got her smiling.

She whispered, "What should I say to him?"

"Tell him you saw it," Josh murmured.

"He knows I saw it, baby. He showed it to me." She chuckled and bit his earlobe again.

Josh chuckled too. The chuckle became a groan as she squeezed his cock harder. The wet from their sex still oiled his member.

"Tell him what you thought of it."

"I can't do that, Josh. Just come out and say I thought his dick was huge?"

This made Josh groan again. He writhed and humped her hand. The more awful the dirty talk, the better.

But Josh said, “Not what you thought of it. It. Not that, I mean the act of showing it to you.”

“Like how he must be proud of it and that’s why he showed it to me?”

“No, Kimmy.” He grunted and chuckled, hips bucking as she jerked him in tight and slow strokes. “How you didn’t appreciate him doing that.”

“That doesn’t sound fun, Josh. I thought you wanted dirty talk.”

Josh held her wrist, stopping the motion of her grip on his cock. He regarded her with narrow and lusty eyes that struggled to focus.

“Not dirty talk. What you’re really going to say to him.”

“What I might say to him. I’m going to lose my nerve.”

“No pressure, no pressure,” he murmured.

“So I tell him I didn’t appreciate it. Then what?”

“I don’t know. You play it from there.”

She chuckled and kissed his chest. Her hand still pumped slowly, and she said to him, “I hear your brain still putting up barricades so the truth doesn’t come out. Tell me what you’d never want me to say. That’s the fantasy. Tell me one thing you would never want me to say to him.”

Josh groaned and squirmed, pushing his cock through the slick grip of her fist. “Oh fuck, I don’t know . . .”

She jerked faster for a moment, got him bouncing on the bed, stomach heaving in and out. “You say ‘I don’t know’ one more time and I swear, Josh, we’re never going to play this game ever again.” And to give him a glimpse of what that future might be like, she released his throbbing erection and slapped his stomach right over his navel. He groaned, covered

his eyes with a forearm. Her hand went right back before he came to his senses and said she was right that they should never play this game again. Once the stroking began, Josh melted into the bed. “Tell me . . .”

“The worse would be if you told him you wanted to see it again, right there in his office.”

She giggled—not just at the ridiculous image that sentence provoked, but the actuality that she could say that to Devlin and he would do it for her, pull his manhood out right in her office. She agreed. “That would be awful. I’m definitely going to say that. I’m going to ask for a private show.”

“Don’t you dare,” he said, in good humor, getting into it, the two of them sharing a joke together.

There should be guilt in her heart, and she supposed somewhere deep down guilt was there, but she was a predator on the hunt, hot on the trail of a delicious meal. She was chasing Josh’s kink down. She would chase it down, but it was wily. It would take more than speed and grace and power. It would take cunning. Josh’s psyche was wily and unpredictable. Capricious and emotional, subject to wild orthogonal action. If she relied on bloodlust, it could escape her. Her prey needed nurturing and trust and care. All of which was natural to her. All of which was true. This was the cunning.

“How about this: Josh told me you took your trunks down, but I didn’t see. What did I miss, Devlin?”

“That’s perfect,” Josh said, a rumble of laughter threatening in his chest.

It was ludicrous, but her husband’s hardness and the way he covered his eyes from hers proved to her this was exactly what he really wanted. But hated that he wanted. “What if I really said that, Josh? Can you imagine?”

“That fucking asshole would be on you in a second.”

“I don’t doubt it,” she said, laughing, and instead of eclipsing him, climbed right over top of his body. They were chest to chest and hipbone to hipbone;

her hands sought out his hands while her stomach squirmed against his rock hard cock. “It is a sexy thought.”

“What do you mean?” he said, vulnerability exposed, his hands in her hands, held out on either side.

She said, “What would I do if he got on me?”

Josh’s face soured for a moment, and she realized she wasn’t as cunning as she thought. There was that wily psyche of Josh’s; that timid little interior rabbit shying away from the truth. Josh hated being shown the things that tormented him and she’d just put in his mind the image of her on her back at Tiffany’s cottage and Devlin humping between her legs. He hated that. Hated that he liked it. Couldn’t accept it.

“Hey,” she said, and flexed her stomach, ballooning it out to put pressure on his erection. “Don’t get morose. I swear to God, I’ll slide right off you, get in the shower, and it’s right back to non-kinky sex for us. I’ll cut a hole in the sheet, and we can do it without looking at each other from now on.”

That opened Josh’s expression like a flower. His smile returned, his mind veering away from that image of his wife being laid out by his high school bully. And that was only part of the truth that Josh knew of that night. “So, I’m not saying that. Is that what you’re telling me?”

“He wants to fuck you,” Josh said tonelessly.

“I’m not special, Josh. I think Devlin probably wants to fuck everything.”

Josh raised an eyebrow, considering it. She wasn’t wrong. Josh agreed.

“Forget the fantasy,” he said. “What would you really say?”

“I’m not sure. If I say that I didn’t appreciate it, where do we go from there? What would Devlin say?” She humped her stomach against him again, her pelvis tilting forward and back. He’d say . . .” She rolled up her eyes to the ceiling. “He’d say that it’s his property—”

“His dad owns it.”

“And he can do what he wants there. It’s a human body, what’s the big deal? he’d add.”

“And you’d say”—Josh raised his voice high and breathy, imitating hers—
“You did it in front of my husband.”

Now Kimmy spoke in a deep-voice imitation of Devlin. “Josh stripped down too. You kept your clothes on. According to your husband and I, it’s you that was the problem.”

Josh laughed at her imitation; hard enough to bounce her on his stomach. But that got her slick tummy sliding against the head of his cock, and he groaned with lust again.

She continued in Devlin’s voice. “Josh and I are on the same page. Kinda rude, us guys getting at-one-with nature and this stuck up lawyer keeps her swimsuit on. Way to make us feel like heels, Kimmy Chang.”

Josh laughed and groaned and hugged her. “I hate that he calls you Chang. Fucking drives me crazy.”

“How do you think I feel?”

“Like you’re not married.”

She squinted. “That’s stupid. I am married. Just because he calls me Chang doesn’t make me think I don’t have a husband at home.”

“Nah, he does it for my benefit. Make me worry that you’ll think that—”

“How can I forget? I come home every night and you’re here. What am I going to do, come in some time and go, ‘Jesus, who’s this guy in my apartment?’”

“Call the cops on me.”

“You’ll be showing them your driver’s license, going, ‘Officer, I live here.’”

“It’s like an episode of Black Mirror.”

She laughed at that. This was why she loved this man. Who else could you play around with this way? Who else could you feel such a friendship with even when you were in bed and you were naked. It's not that Josh was harmless, it's that she loved him. At this point, everything she wanted to do with Devlin was more for Josh than for her. It had been for her, but now she would subjugate herself to Devlin for her husband's benefit. Of course, that was still her benefit—sexually and restoratively.

She kissed her husband on the mouth, dragged her body up his, curling her pelvis forward, gliding the belly of his cock into her still engorged labia, then sitting on him. She drummed on his naked chest and Josh folded his hands under his head. He looked casual and confident.

"I don't think we should let this fantastic erection go to waste," she said.

"No, we shouldn't."

She reached behind, used her fingers to guide his tip into her opening, then sat back, letting him sink inside her body again. "You're so hard right now," she said and laughed.

"Look at you," he said, eyes narrowed and studying her with admiration. "How could I not be hard?"

"How come Devlin didn't get hard then?"

"On the beach? Must have been thinking about baseball and his grandmother. Maybe his grandmother playing baseball."

"You don't think he'd want me to see it when it was hard? I bet he'd love that."

"I think you can get arrested for doing that if the woman's not willing."

"Not in Cayman," she said.

Then, imitating her imitation of Devlin, he said, "Private property, bro."

She assumed the Devlin-voice as well. “What happens in Cayman stays in Cayman, bro.”

“Bro,” Josh said again, making a mean face, trying to look like Devlin.

She snickered and said, “He doesn’t see even say bro. Why do we make him say that?”

“He seems like the kind of guy who would say bro.”

“He’s a lot smarter than I thought, sometimes.”

Josh’s brows knit together. “Are you saying this to get me going?”

“No, I’m serious. Some of the shit he comes up with . . . Well, sometimes it’s amateur psychotherapy, and sometimes it’s broad misinterpretations of Nietzsche and Kierkegaard.”

“Hundred percent that guy only reads white male philosophers.”

She laughed, began to hump with Josh’s steely rod inside her. Her breath turned into a whisper. “You feel really good right now.”

“Kimmy needs every inch she can get.”

She laughed and then chastised him, slapping his chest and saying stop.

“Take it,” he said, flexing his butt and making his cock swell. “This is as good as you’re going to get it, right here.”

“This is it?” She arched her back and looked up at the ceiling—putting on a show for Josh. She squeezed her own nipples, knowing he was watching. Knowing it would make him wild.

“You’re not going to get your stomach touched.”

“I don’t think I want that,” she said, rolling her hips now. She had every bit of her husband inside her, and she was going to come.

As Josh's groaning began and his hands gripped her hips, she flopped forward, her hands on either side of his head, hair dangling toward him. "You know what I'm going to say to Devlin? . . ."

"Tell me," he gasped.

"This is it, for real. I'm really going to say this, Josh."

"Tell me."

She bucked her hips quicker, watched Josh's mouth fall open. His penis was flexing and cabling inside her, her grip on him driving him wild. "I'm going to say . . . I didn't know the Cayman Beach was clothing optional."

"It's good."

"Right? Then listen, I'm going to say next time I'm down there maybe I won't bring a swimsuit."

"Jesus, Kimmy."

"Is that too bad?"

"Then he's going to come to Cayman next time, for sure."

"Don't you want him to?"

"Oh God," Josh said, laughing and groaning. "No, I don't."

"Think about it."

Josh grimaced. "I hate it."

"Exactly," she said, slapping his cheek and getting his eyes open. She kissed his mouth. "That's what I'm really going to say," she whispered, and kissed him again.

"It only makes sense," Josh said.

“What makes sense?”

“Devlin and I stripped, and you didn’t.”

“You want me to . . . you want him to see me naked?”

Josh laughed. “Oh God, he’d fucking lose his mind seeing how hot my wife is.”

“Yeah, right after you lost your mind. You’d pass out before you saw his reaction.” She chuckled and kissed his mouth. They rocked with each other for a long while, breathing heavy, enjoying the feel of their connection. She whispered, “He saw you naked, Josh.”

“You told me not to care. I didn’t care.”

“He didn’t say anything. You said he’d make fun of you.”

“He wouldn’t do it in front of you.”

“He never said it when I drove him back to his hotel. He’s got nothing to make fun of, Josh. I don’t want something touching my stomach, and I can tell you right now, what you’ve got is going to make me come in about two more minutes.”

“I rock your world, huh?”

“We showed him,” she said. “We sure showed him.”

“I bet you he jerked off thinking about it. Thinking about your noises.”

“So gross,” she said, turning her nose up.

“So, you don’t believe Amy?”

She gasped, her admission of the approaching orgasm not any charade at all. She was going to come. Twice in a row. “What, that she’s, mm, been ruined for every other man?”

“She said that?”

“Amy’s such a big talker. She’s full of shit.”

Josh said, “She’s a lawyer.”

For a second, Kimmy agreed, then said, “Hey—” and opened her eyes, smiling, but sitting up with her hands on his chest like she was giving him CPR. “I’m a lawyer.”

Josh laughed as well as though he’d forgotten it himself. “Sorry,” he said.

“You chased my orgasm away.”

“Get it again,” he said, hands on her hips, rocking her weight with his erection all the way inside her.

A nasty glimmer of an idea showed in a tiny crack in her thoughts. And she opened it wider, peeked beyond, seeing an opportunity. It was dangerous. But she was cunning. And even when her cunning produced the wrong result, it was slippery enough to avoid consequences. This endeavor would take risks if it were to work. Josh was not going to walk through the doorway on his own. He would have to be shown the way. She got close, hovered over him, nestled her face between his shoulder and ear. She whispered, “Amy saw your cock.”

It worked. Josh’s cock flexed hard inside her and his whole body stiffened. For a brief moment, she felt the sting of jealousy. Like Josh enjoyed the idea of Amy seeing his erection.

He hissed in disbelief: “What?”

“She peeked when I helped you pee.”

“She saw it?”

“Not my fault, Josh. I told her not to look.”

“What the fuck?”

“Don’t stop, Josh,” she said, sought his hands out again and laced her fingers through them. Josh’s torment and the enjoyment he hated from it spurred her on as well—this was the sickest, wildest kind of play to engage in. Worse than cheating.

She humped Josh faster now, obliterating her husband’s fearful thoughts.

He whispered, “She saw it?”

“I was holding it so you could pee and I told her not to look.”

“I know,” he gasped, expression between a grimace and ecstasy.

“But she peeked.”

“You didn’t stop her?”

“I was trying to hold your dick steady.”

“Oh my God,” he said in a draggy groan.

“Are you going to come?”

Josh nodded.

“I’m going to come, too. Look at me.”

Their gazes connected, and her mouth fell open like Josh’s. Their entire focus existed between their legs. Her husband buried inside her body, hard as a rock and streaming slippery lubrication. He was going to come. They were going to come together. As it drew nearer and nearer, and her vision blurred, she flopped down over him again, and as she felt the first jolts of semen erupt, she said, “Amy saw your naked cock hard as steel, every inch you have pointed up at the moon—”

“What did she say, Kimmy?”

“And she’s seen Devlin’s cock hard.”

“Kimmy, are you kidding me?” Josh twisted and writhed underneath her in exquisite agony. She’d delivered to him a laser point of his kink. She was good at this. Josh jolted and bucked. The noises he made were of awful suffering.

Josh groaned and suffered, cock still jumping and flexing inside her, filling her up with his second load of the morning.

VI

Tuesday, August 25

Supposition

Tuesday morning, before lunch, Josh got an unexpected call to his personal phone.

When the name Devlin Stone displayed on the screen of his iPhone, Josh chilled. The name carried so much existential dread. Though that was attenuating, wasn't it? Kimmy led him away from Devlin's power. It was all in his head, and Kimmy helped show him that. But old habits die hard, and when you see an incoming phone call from the dude who made your youth miserable, you couldn't help your throat constricting, your chest tightening, the pounding of your heart.

But he'd answered it. Answered it because the plot had twisted. Now that existential dread brought a strange glimmer of hope. No, not hope. Desire. Lust. Dirtiness.

By the time he'd tapped to receive the call, he somehow transformed from timid angst-ridden Josh from high school to something even more evolved from the Josh that emerged on vacation in Grand Cayman. He lounged back in his office chair, kicking away from his work, wondering what nefariousness would emerge from this phone call. Devlin couldn't harm him anymore. He and Kimmy had worked together somehow to make the poisonous thorn stuck in his growth rings squeeze out and slide down his bark. Now nothing emerged from that hole but a sickly sweet syrup. "Hey Devlin, what's going on?" That's what he said? Like a call from an old buddy. Well, sure, last time they saw each other, they'd shared a nice steak dinner.

"Hey Josh, how's it going?"

“Just fine. You in Toronto?”

“On my way,” Devlin had said.

That meant it had been six days since Kimmy had seen Devlin Stone. Kimmy’s boss a whole week away from work in Toronto, and yesterday, too, but it looked like now he was returning. Would Kimmy bring up with Devlin the dirty thing he and she discussed in bed on Sunday morning?

If she did or didn’t, it didn’t even matter anymore. It was all fun, anyway. He doubted Kimmy would do it. That would be going too far. And yet . . . Part of him did want her to really do it.

Their niceties over with, talk about the weather, Josh mentioning again how great it was in Cayman—I got some good color on me and it hasn’t left yet—Devlin said, “I’m going to be going past Ajax at lunch time. I don’t have a meeting till two. Meet me for lunch.”

And this new Josh, the one less anxious and war-torn, said, “Sure. Sounds like a great idea. Where you want to go?”

Now he was sitting at The Convivium Café Lounge & Restaurant, feeling foolish. Devlin was late. Fifteen minutes late. Five minutes ago he’d sent a text saying Almost there. And all that protective cocoon shielding his wife delivered to him began to crumble. It all wore away. Devlin was late. He’s making a fool of you. And then, as the minutes ticked on, it became worse. Devlin’s waiting for the others to arrive. Rumble, and some of those other guys. Once they were all here, Devlin would lure him into the bathroom, where they’d beat the shit out of him and humiliate him. Or they’d wait for him to leave in a huff, embarrassed and humiliated that he sat in the restaurant for a lunch date who never showed. Everybody in the restaurant thinking this middle-management loser just got stood up on a date—not knowing he had a beautiful and talented wife at home. He’d storm out of the restaurant, stung and hurting, and four guys would be waiting around the driver’s door of his car with their arms folded. What’s wrong, pipsqueak, get stood up? They’d all share a chuckle. Then one of them would grab him by his tie and bring him up real close, and say—

A tall man stood with the maître d', a young college girl. She pointed toward Josh's table, a smile on her face. Yes, big, tall, handsome guy in a great suit sure could put that expression on a young woman's face. Devlin Stone was here.

Shit. It was so true: he was his own worst enemy. This morning started out with so much confidence. A phone call from Devlin. I can handle that. Have lunch? Sure.

It only took 50 minutes for that façade to crumble and show all the rot in the framework. He'd erected a nice Victorian storefront onto a building with iffy construction, built by nonunion workers under bully foremen who like to give guys wedgies when their heads were turned, hammering in framing nails. His whole foundation was shaky. But this had been a good reminder. And in the end, the façade hadn't crumbled. It had only cracked. The cracks showed him there was still some work to be done, deep in the bare-bones.

He stood up as Devlin approached, then felt stupid. What is this, the 1800s—these are the manners we're using? Instead, he turned it into a moment of stretching, working out kinks in his shoulders and adjusting his jacket. He sat down before Devlin showed up at the table. "Hey Devlin, thought you weren't going to make it."

"Fucking traffic. You eat without me?"

Josh shrugged as Devlin turned away, not even waiting for an answer. He said to the waitress, "Two single malts," unbuttoned his jacket and sat down across the table. He leaned back in the chair, feigning a look of exhaustion, though he was otherwise unruffled. "It's been hectic. Last week, this week. Looking forward to getting out of Kingston."

"What's going on in Kingston?"

"Just a bunch of headaches," Devlin said, then leaned to grab a water glass. He drank half and set it back down. "What're you having?"

"I'm not sure yet, I'm—"

“We should have a couple of steaks. You have long for lunch?”

“Only like half an hour now.”

“Shit,” Devlin said. “Fucking 9-to-5 sucks. I’d rather work 80 hours a week on my own schedule. We can grab something quick.”

“No, I can extend my lunch.”

It pleased Devlin. He winked. “Let’s grab some steaks, Josh.”

“You think they’re going to be as good as in Cayman?”

“I don’t know. Ontario cattle.”

“Yeah, I guess you’re right.”

The waitress returned—offering much better service since Devlin arrived—and set down two short glasses of single malt from her tray. Devlin told her they were ready to order. “My man here has to get back to the office, so we’ve got to be quick. We’re going to have steaks, the New York strip, rare as you can legally make them. Shouldn’t take too long, right?”

“I can have it out to you really quick,” the girl said, smiling like she was dazzled, not even looking at Josh anymore. She disappeared from the table.

Devlin turned to watch her go, the girl’s butt swinging side-to-side in a black waitress skirt. He gave a look of admiration, but said nothing.

“Fucking Cayman,” he sighed as he returned his gaze to the table.

“It was pretty great.”

“Hope you guys get out there again.”

“I guess that’s up to Kimmy.”

“It’s up to me, I think. But I like Kimmy. I’m sure she’ll impress me again.”

“I’m sure she will, too,” Josh said and raised the whisky glass silently to his wife before taking another drink.

“Kind of a surprise, don’t you think?—Me calling for lunch.”

“I sure didn’t expect it,” Josh said.

Devlin looked down, then raised his eyes, peering slyly across the table from under his brow. “Yeah, look, I know you probably don’t like me. I totally get it.”

“No—”

“I don’t expect you to, Josh.” Devlin raised his eyebrows now, lifted the whisky glass to sip. “I get it, like I said. But school was a long time ago. Kimmy’s a fantastic lawyer. You and I have got to figure our shit out. That’s why I wanted to have lunch with you. I can hear the disdain in your tone, every time you talk to me.”

“I’m not doing that on purpose.”

“I’m not saying you are. What I’m saying is we’ve got to get past that. I don’t want to hear that tone of voice.” Devlin held up both hands to stop Josh before he said anything. “Not because it bothers me. . . . Well, it does because I don’t think I deserve it anymore. We should do it for Kimmy’s benefit. And what’s good for Kimmy is going to be good for both of us,” he said, wagging a finger between them. “Don’t you think?”

“Yeah. I would say so.”

“So how do we get past this?”

Josh expected a squirming stomach. But he felt nothing except flatness. Like a soda bottle left out for two days with the lid off. You expect fizz, take a swig, and find the opposite. He leaned forward with his elbows on the table, making sure no server would arrive to interrupt them.

“Let’s just be honest,” he said in an even tone, voice low and serious. “I want you to tell me the truth.”

Devlin said, “Shoot— Ask me and I’ll tell you, Josh.”

“What happened at Tiffany’s cottage?”

“What about it?”

Josh repeated: “What happened at Tiffany’s cottage?”

“Kimmy told you.”

“Not between you and Kimmy. Kimmy told me about that. What happened between you and me?”

Devlin leaned back, eyebrow arched like it amused him. “This is what it comes down to? This thing you keep saying to me and I don’t know what it is? It’s like you expect I know something I don’t know.”

Josh persisted. “Did I talk to you?”

“For a little. Yeah.”

“What did I say?”

“I don’t really remember, Josh.” He leaned forward again. “This is what it all really comes down to?”

An uncomfortable yet shakeable feeling shivered through him. Josh of three months ago would have withered being face-to-face with Devlin this way. Yet now he was armored against his most feared tormentor. Sitting across the table from him like this, he felt no fear. Not anymore. That was Kimmy’s doing. “It really does.”

Devlin leaned back again, eyebrows raised; like a man in a confessional with nothing to hide. “It was you and me at the table. Kimmy was talking to somebody. I don’t remember. I was watching her. You were watching me watch her, and then you started talking about her, unprovoked. Amy came over—”

“Amy wasn’t with Kimmy?”

“I guess they were. Kind of. I mean, they weren’t attached at the hip or anything.”

“This was at the picnic table?”

“Yeah. You and I were at the picnic table. You were . . . Can I be frank?”

“Drunk,” Josh said.

“Sloppy, dude. Super sloppy. I stay away from bourbon. Too easy to down it.”

“It snuck up on me.” He fiddled with the clean cutlery a moment, eyes averted to his hands. Not fearful to look into Devlin’s black eyes, but lost in the fog of that night’s war. He should be angry at this guy. Should be angry that Devlin tried to make out with his wife while he was drunk. But an emptiness swirled around that knowledge now. The bitter tang of that truth had been sweetened by Kimmy. They’d worked together to transform it into something else. Something that united them as husband and wife rather than separate them. He looked up again. “But what did I say? What did you say?”

Devlin laughed and looked up at the restaurant’s high ceiling. “About what, Josh?” He was amused, but exasperated. “Just tell me what it is, because I swear to you, Josh, I have no idea what you’re talking about.”

“And you never came into my tent later?”

Devlin put up his hands. “Why the hell would I do that?— Oh no, did you have a nightmare about me and you think I did something I didn’t do?”

Josh smiled a little, the amusement on Devlin’s face showcasing some of the humor in the very things he was saying. Dammit. He really was his own worst enemy. He said, “Amy was there?”

“Yeah. She was hanging with me.”

“Did she say something to me?”

“Yes. She was between us. She was saying stuff to you.”

“What was it?”

Devlin shrugged, like the pressure for minuscule details from months ago irritated him. It was trivial to Devlin, but not to Josh. Devlin said, “I wasn’t paying attention. It was like ten minutes I was sitting there like that. Amy would lean over and say things to you. You guys were getting along.”

“And you’ve never texted me?”

Devlin frowned and looked up like he was trying to recall. “I’ve texted you before, haven’t I?”

The whole escapade got slippery in Josh’s mind. Even he couldn’t grasp his own line of questioning. He was direct and straightforward, giving his old tormentor every opportunity to take credit for a victorious manipulation. But Devlin only showed befuddlement. “You’ve never taunted me?”

“Taunted you about what?”

Josh held a steady expression, watching Devlin’s dark eyes. “Just to bug me after Tiffany’s party.”

Devlin’s gaze stayed firm. Then he shook his head. His eyes down-turned, his brow raised. A little more compassionate than the usual Devlin. He said, “I know you probably expect that from me. But I swear, Josh, I don’t have time for that bullshit anymore. I’m under a lot of pressure. I’ve got a lot of plans on the go. I have a lot on my plate right now. High school . . .” He grew quiet, like there was something he didn’t want to say. He twiddled his thumbs a second, then said, “My home life was stressful. I took a lot of shit out on other people. Did they deserve it? No way. You know some of them kinda asked for it. But that’s still not even their fault. They draw people like me to them. Not that it’s their fault: you can’t blame magnets for their nature.”

“That’s all I want to know. I want to know who texted me after the party to taunt me.”

“What did the text say?”

“If it wasn’t you who sent it, I’m not even going to think about it. I had a suspicion—”

Devlin’s eyes darted to Josh’s. Then he laughed. “Amy. Is that your suspicion?”

“I thought maybe—”

Devlin shook his head, still chuckling. “That bitch is so crazy, dude. I don’t know how can we can be friends with her. She is a straight up serial killer.”

And like that, the line of questioning went into his rearview mirror, and he wasn’t sure what he’d seen. His mind scrambled to make sense of it. But Devlin’s warmth and the reasonable doubt iterated here at the table got Josh relaxed a little. “Yeah,” he said, “that new haircut doesn’t help.”

“I know,” Devlin said. “She is fucked up. And, honest to God, that girl will do anything in bed. Not that you need to know that about Amy, but I feel it has to be said.” He lounged in his chair, pleased with himself. “So what you’re telling me is Amy charged you up over something and you blamed me.” And then, almost admiringly, he said, “My God, I bet that girl set me up. Probably worked to make it seem like it was me. . . . Amy is an unregistered sex offender, Josh.”

Something about this talk of nefarious Amy aroused him. A heaviness throbbed between his legs, thinking about it. And thinking about something else—thinking about his wife’s involvement with such nefarious sexual players. Josh leaned in and said, “Kimmy said . . .” And then he lost his nerve. Then got it again. “Said Amy tried to get her in bed.”

Devlin smirked to one side, unsure of what he should say. He nodded, eyeing Josh with careful measure.

Josh offered it up to let Devlin off the hook, encourage him to reveal the truth. “In bed with you and Amy I mean.”

“Yes,” Devlin said, nodding but expressionless, afraid to laugh or smile without knowing Josh’s thoughts. “She did do that. You know Kimmy took off, right?”

“She told me.”

“I had no idea Amy was going to do that. I thought she brought a friend over to study. Kimmy showed up in a”—he drew a figure over the center of his chest—“like a sweatshirt with a—”

“Bunny on it or something.”

“Something like that. Some cartoon character. She looked like she was twelve.”

“She doesn’t look like it now.” Saying it out loud made Josh’s heart beat faster.

“No,” Devlin said, smiling and looking off, “not at all. Not at all.”

The way he said it, earnest and salacious, punched Josh in the stomach. But it was the truth. And of course Devlin noticed. Devlin was fucking responsible for Kimmy’s transformation. Kimmy wouldn’t look the way she did now if she hadn’t met Devlin at Tiffany’s party.

“She likes her job,” Josh said.

“I’m glad to hear that.”

“Yep,” they both said, their talk dwindling—Josh not sure how much more he could say without making a mistake—both of them looking around to see if their food would arrive soon. They drank more whiskey, then Devlin chin-pointed. Josh looked over his shoulder to see their lunch on the way.

The waitress arrived, proud of her efficiency. It had been a fast service. The restaurant wasn’t that busy, and Devlin prompted her best performance.

“Here we go, guys. Can I get you anything else?”

They declined, and Devlin waved her off. Josh said after her, “We’re good, thanks.”

Devlin cut into his steak, unimpressed. He examined it for a second, then changed his mind, beginning to nod and show a satisfied expression. “Pretty fucking good.”

“I’m starving,” Josh said.

Devlin took another bite. Chewed. Took a sip of water. Looked up and met Josh’s eyes. “So, are we going to talk about what the heck was going on with you two in Cayman?”

Heat raced the back of Josh’s neck. “What do you mean?”

Devlin’s amused eyes narrowed. “You guys were playing some game on me. I don’t know what it was.”

Josh’s throat went dry, and he cleared it. “I don’t think we were.”

“Josh, you wanted me to be honest. You be honest too.”

“Yeah, okay.” He shrugged, stuffed another bite in his mouth.

“So what was it?”

“It was just between us. Kimmy and I. This little thing we have going.”

“How am I a part?”

Josh raised his eyebrows. That was a good question. “Not sure you are. It’s not you in particular.”

“What is it? Come on.”

“I don’t know you well enough.” Josh couldn’t help smiling widely, a sly feeling passing over him. He laughed, took a sip of water and another bite

of steak.

“No, I guess not. I like it, whatever it was. I heard you give it to her good.”

Josh chuckled and let go a chuffing of disbelief. A wild tingle of taboo shivered. They were talking about something they shouldn't talk about and it was about his wife.

Devlin smiled too, just like Josh, leaned close and conspiratorial and whispered across the table. “Hey, Josh, what's Kimmy like in bed?”

Unagi

For lunch, she ordered an Energy Unagi roll and a seaweed salad from Hashi Izakaya. Crispy shrimp, crabmeat, and cream cheese, topped with barbecued eel, only half eaten, the remains stacked in black plastic trays on Devlin's coffee table. It was 12:45 now. Devlin told her they'd meet at his place for lunch.

She wouldn't text him. Wouldn't give him the satisfaction. Devlin wanted to play games with her, but he didn't know who he was playing with.

On his leather couch, shoes off, bare feet crossed on the table, she flicked through her phone. Checked Instagram, checked Facebook. Her suit jacket hung inside the front door of the apartment. Devlin hadn't moved any of his things in yet, and didn't take possession till the first of the month. Melody gave him the key. The unit wasn't occupied, anyway. It would give him more time to move his things in.

Kimmy anticipated this apartment would be the spot she spent a few lunch hours a week. But they hadn't met here at all last week. She hadn't even seen Devlin. Though she texted, Devlin gave nothing away. Didn't say or allude to anything that bothered him. But she determined from this fact the proof she needed that Devlin was playing games. It was coy and sly. Behavior she deemed below Devlin. More the kind of maneuvering she would expect from someone less confident. Unless there was something he was up to she didn't see.

She tossed her phone to the couch, got up and strolled around the apartment, arms folded, liking the cool feel of the hardwood under her bare soles. She stood at the window a long while, looking at nothing, watching

cars pass on the road beyond. Then caught herself, not realizing it at first: was she looking for his car to arrive?

Don't be so needy.

It would be great to see him. The last time she'd spent with Devlin, they'd fucked on the hotel balcony in Cayman. She stroked her upper arms, feeling a warm tingle low in her stomach. Where the fuck was he?

When her phone dinged with an incoming text, she dashed straight to it. Then slowed the rushing, not wanting Devlin to see her eager. It would be a great idea to get back to the office right now. Then when he arrived she could text back from the office like she forgot she was supposed to meet him today.

But the text wasn't from Devlin, it was from Josh. She chewed her lip a moment before letting face recognition reveal the text to her.

Josh: Guess who I had lunch with.

Now she gnawed her inner cheek, a bizarre sense this guessing game could be part of her own current puzzle. Josh had lunch with Devlin. But that was stupid. Josh had a life of his own that had nothing to do with her nefarious activities. If it wasn't Meyer Josh had lunch with, who would it be? Not Steve. These were both people he had lunch with all the time. He wouldn't text about them. Sophie, maybe. Hyun and Sophie? Amy? Oh, what about Karina? She had no witty answer for Josh, and now felt guilty in Devlin's apartment and talking to her husband at the same time. At least Devlin wasn't here. She texted back.

Kimmy: Who?

The dots danced, and she waited for an answer. Then the dots stopped.

She gathered her things, threw out her Unagi leftovers, put on her pumps, slipped on her jacket, stood at the door a moment and checked her phone. More dancing dots, then a text arrived.

Josh: I had lunch with your boss. Called me out of the blue. We went to Convivium in Ajax. Had a steak. You know how it is.

She frowned, wondering when it was they had lunch. Devlin said he would be here, in his apartment.

So this was Devlin's game.

She growled, raked fingers through her hair—reminding herself to tie it in a bun before she returned to the office. Devlin's game was to shame her while he had lunch with her husband. The horny adulteress left unsatisfied, her lover taunting her and her husband. What was his message? that he satisfied her husband's kink instead of hers?

She texted in return.

Kimmy: What the hell?

Josh: I know!

What would they have talked about over lunch? What would Josh have told Devlin? Her mind scanned the most dangerous things Josh could say to Devlin. Devlin would be unwise to jeopardize her relationship with her

husband, knowing it would jeopardize her work relationship with him. This impromptu lunch meeting was meant to taunt Josh. Not meant to fuck with her. But then why wouldn't he just tell her? It was a weak attempt at controlling their narrative. Devlin thought he was in control.

She growled again, lips pursed and shaking her head, looking at the happy words from her husband. Josh not knowing someone else was working him towards sexual manipulation. While she had Josh's best interest at heart, Devlin did not.

She had to be in control.

With that, she slipped out of the apartment and locked it behind her and made her way to the elevator banks.

She texted Josh.

Kimmy: What did you guys talk about?

Josh: You weren't kidding about amateur psychotherapy. Tried to run something on me about how humiliation is a gift

So Devlin was working that power-vacuum angle on Josh now. Trying to lure Josh into some sort of trap. Devlin sought to humiliate Josh. She sought only to deliver what her husband craved. Did Josh want humiliation? She definitely didn't think so. He wanted suffering. Not humiliation. She shook her head again, getting mad. The elevator dinged, and she boarded the car, looked at her annoyed reflection in the mirrored doors as they closed. Her phone dinged.

Josh: Guess where I'm going Friday

Kimmy: Where?

Josh: Jays game, box seats with your boss.

“Oh Josh,” she sighed.

Later, at the office, around two o'clock, she was engrossed in work again. Thoughts of Devlin subsided, and she hated what was left in its wake. Horniness. She'd built up desire, wanting Devlin to show up. She really had wanted him today. Had missed seeing him. Had counted on it. But once her computer was on, and she was scanning documents, Devlin was banished from the foremost point in her mind. A certain soggy feeling remained.

At one point, thinking about her horniness encouraged a small, curling smile. At first, she thought she was going to fuck Josh's brains out when she got home tonight. And when that didn't sate the desire she felt, a kinkier thought: Josh couldn't fuck the way Devlin did, but what could really make her come was tormenting Josh to bring out the worst in him. To bring out that dirty, awful orgasm he hated. Make him fall in love with it. The plan was devious, but since Cayman, it was the thing really getting her off.

She almost jumped when Tami knocked on the glass of her office door. She pushed her chair back and waved Tami in. Tami looked concerned and harried, her posture stooped.

Kimmy asked her what was going on.

“Sorry to bother you,” Tami said in a hushed voice. “Have you seen Devlin?”

“No, I haven’t. You haven’t seen him?”

“I thought maybe you had lunch with him.”

She bristled. Was that the kind of thing Tami thought? Was she being surveilled by her secretary? “I didn’t have lunch with Devlin.”

“You went out, I just thought maybe you met up with—”

“No,” she said, wanting to argue the point more, but knowing that somehow would make her feel guiltier and maybe give something away to Tami.

“Why?”

Tami stepped further in, but kept the office door open. She whispered louder, “His dad’s here.”

“Devlin’s dad?”

“Yeah, he’s looking for him.”

“I don’t know where he is. What does his dad want?”

“I don’t know. I think it’s important.”

“Oh,” Kimmy said, and snapped her fingers, a lifesaver thrown to her out of nowhere. She wasn’t at lunch with Devlin, not at all, Tami. “I think he’s coming into Toronto. He had lunch with my husband.”

“He had lunch with Josh?”

“Yes. We all went to high school together, remember?”

“Oh yeah.”

“So Devlin was in Ajax an hour ago. Tell him Devlin will be here later, probably. He’s not answering his phone?”

Tami shook her head no.

“That’s strange.”

Tami was still perplexed. Devlin’s father was intimidating, and she’d come in here for some news, but didn’t think she got enough. “You want to talk to him?”

“Talk to— Oh, you mean talk to Devlin’s dad. . . . Only if he asks for me.”

Tami leaned in closer and whispered even quieter now, making elaborate mouth movements so Kimmy could lipread. “I think he’s pissed at Devlin.”

Kimmy nodded, understanding that Tami wanted someone else to take care of the problem, someone with more authority. Kimmy rose from her office chair, straightened her jacket, and gestured for Tami to go ahead. Tami scooted behind her front office desk and got busy with work. Devlin’s father stood facing away, hands on hips, in that same Superman pose Devlin often assumed. He studied an original piece of art in their foyer, a six-foot wide landscape of nothing but swirls and patches of color.

Kimmy addressed him and he turned to regard her. While Devlin was a devil in black, his father was all in silver. Silvery Glen plaid suit, white shirt, steel tie; thick waves of long, graying hair brushed back from his tanned and chiseled face. But his eyes were as dark as his son’s, gleaming with sly intellect. And while Devlin’s eyes often showed an exuberant malevolence, his father’s showed the same, but honed by wisdom.

Under his gaze, she re-introduced herself. “Good afternoon, Mr. Stone. I’m Ms. Chang, the—”

“I remember. Kimmy.” His gaze stayed firm and uncompromising. “How are you doing?”

“I’m well, thank you. Devlin hasn’t been in today, but I assume he’ll be here shortly. He was in Ajax about an hour ago.”

“That’s where you live.”

She didn't know what to make of that. Didn't know what relevance Devlin's father construed, enough he would mention it now. And didn't know if she should mention Devlin's lunch with Josh. Was that a frivolous thing? Would Devlin's father see his son painted as a gallivanting flâneur? Devlin wasn't lazy, but she also wasn't quite sure what he really produced. He always seemed to know where the business was going and what needed to be done, but he didn't ever get caught with his hand on the wheel. Then again, maybe Devlin needed a challenge. She said to his father, "That's right, he took my husband out for lunch."

Devlin's father received it without reaction. "When was that?"

"I talked to my husband about an hour ago, so if Devlin left Ajax to come to Toronto after lunch, he should be here soon."

"What does your husband do?"

"Market research at AJ Swanson."

"Good outfit."

"He's happy there."

Now Mr. Stone surveyed her. Not lecherously, nor appreciatively, though she assumed those perspectives existed in Devlin's father—why else would his eyes roam her body? He said, "When you see him, tell him to call." His tone was dry and calm, yet commanding.

"I will certainly do that, Mr. Stone," she said with no hesitation.

"Take care, Mrs. Chang," Devlin's father said, and dismissed their conversation with a hand wave. The gesture wasn't insulting. It was authoritative. A top-down command missing from the Toronto office. It might take years for Devlin to earn the gravitas his father showed.

Mr. Stone departed with no more said.

Once he'd descended in the elevator, the glowing light showing his cab heading down to the ground floor, Tami said to Kimmy, "He's so

intimidating.”

Kimmy shrugged, returning to her office. “That’s a man you don’t mess around with.”

Ploy

At a quarter-to-five, Devlin finally showed. She was at her desk, talking on the phone with Ruth in charge of records out of the Kingston office. Devlin strolled into the lobby from the elevator like everything was perfect. Tami's cheeks flushed at seeing Devlin. Still talking with Ruth, Kimmy watched Tami and Devlin exchange pleasantries, Devlin smiling, Tami nodding. Devlin gestured toward Kimmy's office.

“That’s great, Ruth,” Kimmy said, “I’ll follow-up tomorrow. If you find it, send it to my email.” She hung up as Devlin entered her office.

She said nothing, the office quiet, Devlin coming in amused, looking at her heron painting for a moment before plopping down in one of the chairs on the other side of her desk.

“You’ve had some day,” she said.

“Busy-busy,” he said.

“Aren’t we all?”

Devlin slouched in the chair, a passive pose he didn’t usually assume. But there was still a rakish command in his demeanor. Suit jacket open, hair lightly ruffled but still looking put-together.

Kimmy began packing her things away, looking to head home. While pushing paperwork into her satchel, she said, “Heard you had lunch today with Josh.”

“Indeed, I did,” he said, smiling slyly, elbows on the leather armrests and his fingers steepled.

“Good for you.”

Devlin studied her a moment. “Are you sore?”

“Sore about what?”

“Sore I missed our lunch.”

She resumed riffling paperwork to take home. “Did we have a thing today?”

“You didn’t think we did?”

More paperwork sorting. “I thought perhaps.”

Devlin smiled. “Someone was in my apartment today eating eel from Izakaya. I hope it was you.”

She’d forgot about her trash. “I ate lunch in your apartment. It was quiet.”

“I was having lunch with our mutual friend.”

She smiled now, lured in by his playful but devious banter. Elbows on the desk, she steepled her fingers like he did. “He’s more than a friend to me. He tells me you’re taking him to the Jays game.”

“Are you jealous?”

“I don’t follow baseball.”

Devlin shrugged a shoulder. “Great food. Great libation. Maybe I’ll take Josh out to a strip club.”

“Try it and see what happens.”

Devlin’s delight showed in his eyes and the tighter curl to one corner of his smile. “Maybe I’ll do that. How bad would you punish me?”

“I’d punish Josh, not you,” she said and smiled as well.

“I might turn Josh into a howling poon dog.”

“Josh doesn’t howl.”

Devlin crossed one leg over the other. “I’m pretty sure you could make him howl.”

“Your father was here looking for you.”

Devlin waved it off. “I talked to him.”

“After lunch?”

“This afternoon.”

“He didn’t seem happy.”

“Have you met the man? That’s his neutral demeanor.”

“Well, I’m glad you talked to him. I think he scared the pants off Tami.”

“Pop’s scared the pants off many secretaries.” Devlin chuckled to himself.

“Gross,” she said.

“What’s the matter, Kimmy, worried that the Stone men sleep with the staff, that what you and I have isn’t real?”

“We don’t have anything.”

“Then why were you in my apartment today—because it’s quiet? Were you catching up on work? Or were you there looking for something else?”

Denying him would be playing into his game. She said, “You know what I was there for.”

Devlin smiled, getting the answer he wanted. His eyes moved aside to watch Tami packing away her things and turning off her computer for the night. Tami's eyes moved furtively, wanting to look in on them but not wanting to be caught doing it.

Kimmy said, "When your dad came to the office, she came to me thinking I knew where you were."

"Tami's crafty. Did you tell her you lay waiting in my apartment, naked under my bed sheets?"

"I did not tell her that. I told her you had lunch with my husband."

Devlin looked disappointed, saying to himself, "I think your husband has the hots for me more than you do."

She regarded Devlin coolly, tempering that smug and arrogant gleam in his black devilish eyes. But she couldn't help smiling. She said, "Josh only has eyes for me, Devlin."

"You're right about that. I know it. I have him eating out of my hand because I know it."

"Do not mess with him," she said. "I'm warning you."

"Mess with him? I want to make his wildest fantasies come true."

"I don't think he'd be ready for that."

"Time will tell. . . . You know, I had an interesting conversation today."

"With Josh?"

Devlin nodded. "Something Josh said got me calling an old friend of ours."

Kimmy squirmed. "Amy."

Devlin pointed a finger pistol and brought the thumb hammer down.

"Exactly. Seems our devious friend played some games with your

husband.”

Kimmy frowned. “What do you mean, played games?”

“I talked to Amy this afternoon. At lunch Josh tells me he thought I’d hypnotized him, or some shit—that guy watches too many comic book movies—tells me I got in his head to make him do things he didn’t want to do.”

The texting.

Devlin said, “Why didn’t you tell me about that?”

“I didn’t?”

Devlin looked up at the office ceiling and breathed deeply. “Amy’s not a nice person, Kimmy.”

“She’s my friend.”

Devlin chuckled.

“She’s more my friend than yours.”

Devlin looked at her. “Something your husband said to Amy at Tiffany’s party put a busy bee in her bonnet. She took it on herself to whisper sweet-nothings in your husband’s ear.”

She regarded Devlin coolly, not buying what he was selling. “What did she whisper?”

“Amy whispered Josh’s secrets closer to the surface.”

Kimmy raised a mistrustful eyebrow. “Did she?”

“Amy told me your husband wants me to fuck you.”

“You already did that,” Kimmy said, a strange heat on the back of her neck.

Did Amy really manipulate all of this into being?

As outrageous as it might seem, she was sure that if Amy suspected Josh's desire to be true, the events over the last two months were unknowingly approved. Josh might hate the idea, but it did turn him on. Taunting and teasing Josh provided her a strange satisfaction, but to hear others engaging in it made her at once protective and unconfident. Like the only way for this to work for her and Josh was for it to belong to them only.

"We did that together," Devlin said.

Kimmy nodded, studying Devlin, his lounging broad-shouldered body in an expensive suit, one leg crossed over the other and looking self-assured to the point of belligerence. "So our union was predetermined. Fate. Set in motion that night in high school when I rejected you."

"And Amy."

"Amy holds a grudge?"

Devlin nodded once, not affirmation but a supposition. "Amy holds a grudge."

"Excuse me if I don't so readily believe in such orchestrated malevolence from my high school friend."

"This was all your decision. Every step of the way. You had agency this whole time. It was you who decided it would happen."

"But you're implying Amy worked Josh. And didn't you work me? Is that how this started, you and Amy? To what end? To ruin my life, ruin Josh's life?"

"What's been ruined exactly, Miss Chang?"

"It's Waters. Mrs. Waters."

"Mrs. Waters, tell me then what exactly has been ruined? Look how your life's changed the last few months. Look how Josh's life has changed these

last few months. He hasn't even received my gift yet."

She raised her eyebrows with dry indifference. "A trip to a Jays game?"

Devlin smiled and nodded. "No. Allowing him to watch me fuck you."

She couldn't help smiling too, a slippery thrill at hearing such an immoral proclamation.

Devlin continued, working with the sly eagerness he saw in her. "Watching your face as you take every inch, watching your thighs shake as I make you come and come and come. That's what Josh wants, and that's what we're going to give him."

She said, "How are we going to give it to him?"

Devlin uncrossed his legs and sat forward. "You tell me, Kimmy. You tell me."

Thirty minutes later, she sat in the driver's seat of her car, casting cautious glances to the left and right. With no one else in sight, she continued what she was doing. Thumbs hooked in her panties, she scooted her panties down her thighs, and over her knees, a vigilant gaze scanning the apartment windows looming over her windshield like two dozen possible witnesses.

Then the panties were over her knees, down to her shoes and off. She sat up straight as if she weren't doing something awful. The panties she held in a hand in her lap were heavy with dampness. The talk with Devlin in her office had sent her over the top and now she was returned here to this spot to get what she'd wanted earlier today. What she'd wanted for over a week now. Her stomach quivered in anticipation and the insides of her thighs were warm and greased. A fullness flooded her pussy, a ticking desire-bomb counting down, needing what it knew it was about to get and sopping with overflowing anticipation.

Devlin had gone on to his apartment ahead of her, daring her to follow, knowing what they'd discussed over her desk had riled her as much as the way they knew this idea aroused Josh. Devlin had two supplicants coming to his temple to receive their offering. For now, this situation would do, but in time, only one person could be in control of this situation. It could not be Devlin. That left her or Josh, and Josh had planted his head in the sand.

She checked hair and makeup in the rear-view, made sure she had her phone—it was crucial—and hid her dank panties in the console between the seats. Then she was out of the Leaf, walking with bare legs and bare pussy under a short skirt, heels tapping on the asphalt, tugging at her skirt hem.

In the elevator, she made small talk with another tenant, a well-dressed older woman, a Yorkshire Terrier in her arms with a pink bow in its hair. Talking to the woman about innocent things like the weather, knowing the enormous next step she would take in a few minutes, brought goosebumps to her flesh and hardened her nipples—thankfully hidden from the woman and her dog's sight under her suit jacket.

Off on Devlin's floor, waving a goodbye to the Yorkie, she strutted down the hall, pulling out her phone, opening her dictation app, starting a new file, then pressing record.

At Devlin's door, she slipped the phone into her jacket pocket and knocked.

Devlin took his time answering, and when he did, he wore only his suit pants and dress shirt. He said, "I'm glad you could make it, Kimmy. Sorry to drag you out here. I know you want to get home to Josh, but I needed you to look at something."

"Okay," Kimmy said, smiling widely like a high school girl, trying not to burst out laughing. "Show me what you've got, Devlin."

Exposed

Josh ate dinner alone. Kimmy'd texted him from work saying she had an emergency meeting after five o'clock, but she wouldn't be home too late. She'd texted at seven-thirty she was on the road again and would be home soon. At five after eight, she came home and right away he knew something was wrong.

Now he stood at the kitchen pass-through, watching his wife's back as she washed her hands in the sink and then poured herself a glass of water and drank.

He asked her what's going on, unable to hide the nervousness in his voice. The way she'd come in the door, that terrible look on her face . . . Something had happened, and he feared she'd lost her job. The job with Devlin had changed her for the better, and the extra money made them secure.

Kimmy held up a finger, finished her drink, then sat the glass in the bottom of the sink. She bowed her head and her posture slumped. The sight of her this way sunk his heart.

He hustled around the pass-through and into the kitchen to join her. "What is it, what happened?" He turned her to face him and when she looked down, avoiding his eyes, he put his arms around her. Kimmy melted against him. "Tell me," he whispered, brow furrowed, a knot in his stomach, his hands stroking her back.

Kimmy pulled back like she would tell him, then lost her nerve, shaking her head and staring at his chest.

“Is everything okay?” He just wanted to hear that she was all right, that she was still employed, or that her family was all okay. Did she witness an accident on the drive home?

“I did what I said I would do,” she said, voice quiet but with an urgent despair.

“What are you talking about? Did what?”

Now Kimmy’s eyes raised to meet his, and though their gazes met, there was no connection. His wife’s eyes lost somewhere, giving him no indication where her mind was. Her mouth remained open, like she would begin speaking as soon as the words became unstuck from her throat.

“Hey,” he said, almost chuckling now, realizing the benevolent power he held over her: Kimmy couldn’t disappoint him, there was nothing she could have done that would break him. Whatever was wrong could be solved, could be made right. “You’re here, you’re home, everything is okay. Whatever it is, we can figure it out. Your family is all right? It’s not—”

“They’re fine, Josh, everyone’s fine,” she said in a normal tone at last, his worry for her family snapping Kimmy out of it and showing her the terribleness of what Josh might assume bothered her—and how he was here to support her in anything.

The relief of hearing her voice return and seeing a human glimmer in her eyes was huge. He chuckled and hugged her again, and as he did, his brain caught up with her words and the situation.

I did what I said I would do.

“What did you do?”

He held her away with his hands on the curve of her shoulders. He saw fear from her now and realized his features had furrowed to a scowl. His features eased, and he showed her compassion and understanding instead.

Kimmy's mouth worked to speak again, and he lowered his gaze to meet hers. She found the words.

"What I said I would do."

Josh's mind went straight to the gutter, and he hated himself for it. She brought up Devlin's nakedness at work like she told him she would. She'd said something, and the situation went the wrong way. Oh shit— it went badly and they ended up having sex.

The beat of his heart became a gallop and his throat closed in an anxious squeeze. Blood drained from his face.

It couldn't be that. She would never have the nerve to say something to Devlin about the strange things that happened in Cayman.

Now it was him speaking in hesitating jags. "What did you . . . say you would . . . do?"

She looked at him like he was slow, jutting her chin forward and widening her eyes. The muscles in her jaw flexed.

Was it what he thought? His stomach tightened, and the biggest surprise of all: his cock began to grow.

"It went too far, Josh," she said, and then immediately, as if the immense weight of the words she just uttered hit her, her beautiful features scrunched closed and she cried.

"What the hell, Kimmy?" His voice was soft and reassuring and he took her in his arms again, her hot breath dampening the shoulder of his T-shirt. He held her close and made soothing sounds in her ear.

It went too far? What the hell was too far?

His cock grew to full and maximum hardness. While his wife cried in his arms over what she'd done for her husband, her husband's cock went to full iron hardness. The shame brought heat to his cheeks, and he moved his hips back so she wouldn't feel it.

It was thinking the worst of Kimmy that provoked this sudden and intense physical arousal.

“He didn’t touch you or something like that, did he?”

Kimmy shook her head no on his chest, then she sniffled and stepped back, wiping her cheeks and turning to the sink again. She poured herself another glass of water and drank it.

He watched her in silence. Those long perfect legs, the pointed shoes, the lithe, slender frame and the long, silky black hair down her back.

No bun. Her hair had been undone. Had she undone it, or had Devlin?

Josh grabbed his hard-on and squeezed, still admiring his wife’s back. The odd, hard feeling in his stomach somehow felt good. Like he enjoyed the hurt. Though it was wild, he basked in this purgatory of the unknown, not sure what his wife had done, but allowing the fantasy she’d done something dirty with Devlin Stone to wash over him in greenish waves.

Kimmy was blameless, and this was all for him. Whatever she’d done with Devlin tonight, she’d done it to please him.

His hands gripped her collar as she set another empty glass down in the sink. This time she didn’t bow her head in affliction. She put a hand over one of his. He looked at those long and graceful fingers with no colored polish, just a clear coat, and, of course, her wedding ring.

“Devlin didn’t do something that I need to worry about?”

She shook her head again. “No, but I did.”

“You did?”

She nodded and turned to face him, the two of them close and touching, her ass resting against the sink edge. “Devlin did something bad, and I didn’t stop him. I let him.” Her eyes strayed from his again.

Again, Josh asked, “Did he touch you?”

Kimmy covered up her face with both her hands and breathed into them. It hit him suddenly that she was fucking with him. He stepped back and laughed. Kimmy's hands lowered, and she showed him a puzzled look. "What is it?"

"You're messing with me."

Kimmy didn't smile, only looked at him with a hurt and hollow expression. "I'm not messing with you."

The smile stayed on his face a while longer, but as every second ticked away where Kimmy didn't come clean, the more he returned to that horrible angst that tickled him. "You're here, you're alive and unharmed, and Devlin didn't touch you. How bad could it be?— Don't answer. What I mean is I'm here for you and no matter how too far you think it went, I'm here for you. We will figure it out."

Kimmy regarded him for a while, lips sucked in and held between her teeth. They slowly slid out. She said, "I recorded me asking Devlin about the nudity in Cayman and Devlin played along and Devlin went too far and I didn't stop him."

"What did he do?" But deep down, Josh knew what Devlin did. It was so obvious. Devlin pulled his dick out. Devlin pulled his huge dick out and showed it to Kimmy, and Kimmy didn't stop him. Kimmy looked at it.

His cock throbbed harder than ever and his knees weakened.

Kimmy was lost in something else: how what she did tonight for his benefit affected her future. She said, "My relationship with Devlin definitely changed tonight. How can I go back to work, Josh?"

"Why, what happened? What did he do?"

But Kimmy had more pressing matters than his jealousy and the way this kind of kink aroused him. Kimmy was forlorn. Not into playing games with him. Worried about her future.

He took her in his arms again. “Kimmy, it’ll be okay. I’m sure Devlin will be cool about it.”

Her arms looped his waist. “And what about you?”

“I’m definitely cool about it. Don’t worry for a second. Devlin is controllable, and he needs you too much for this to be a problem. Hell, Kimmy, to Devlin, this isn’t a problem at all. Tell me what he did. What do you mean he went too far?”

She hesitated, mouth working around. And then: “I might have ruined my job and our marriage tonight, Josh.”

“No way, Kimmy. No way.”

And for the first time since she’d come through the door tonight, he saw the peek of a smile. Her eyes showed hurt still, but he was getting through to her. “You’re the best, Josh. You really are.” Her voice was barely audible, but the sentiment hit him hard. He hugged her again, this time not even hiding his erection. Kimmy didn’t mention it, but there was no way it went unnoticed.

“Now tell me,” he said.

“If you want me to tell you, I want you vulnerable. As vulnerable as I felt when I did it.”

He hoped she didn’t blame him for whatever happened. “You did it for me?” He cocked his head. “Kimmy, I wouldn’t ask you to do anything that would make you feel how you look right now. I’m sorry, I—”

“I love you, Josh. I really do. I love you so much.”

The sudden change in direction and the honesty in her voice touched him, putting a warm feeling around his heart. “I love you, Kimmy. How can it be so bad if we love each other? You didn’t . . .?”

“No. Josh, no, I didn’t . . .”

“Then tell me. I need to know. How do you want me vulnerable?”

Josh lay vulnerable in their bed, the night sky deepening to the color of a ripe eggplant beyond the bedroom window. What Kimmy required from him—if she were to divulge this awful tale—was his obedience and vulnerability. So Josh lay naked under the bedding, head on the pillow. Kimmy sat on a hip beside him on the bed, supporting her weight with a hand near his knee. The vulnerability this created was stark and unexpected. The act of disrobing while Kimmy remained clothed put him in a powerless position. Looking up in Kimmy’s beautiful eyes with his cock humping out the bedding, he felt an unfamiliar intimidation. He felt manipulated. Maybe even doubtful. Like Kimmy’s disquiet when she arrived home was performative. An act meant to put him on the defense. But there couldn’t be a better way to be manipulated.

Kimmy studied him, long hair hanging in waves around her beautiful face. The tightness of her daytime bun had put curls in her lustrous hair. Her shirt collar was open almost to her breastbone. Whatever Kimmy did with Devlin tonight, Devlin’s eyes watched that triangle of flesh she revealed. Her tawny skin stretched tight over the swoop of her collarbone, her long and graceful neck, the tendons showing. Her simple necklace glinted gold.

Eager to begin, he said, “Is this okay?”

Kimmy nodded, then licked her lips. Her expression was somber.

He said, “Can you please tell me what happened now?”

Kimmy nodded again, her eyes moving to the folded-over edge of the sheets across his chest. She sat straighter, tucked a thumb under that edge, warm skin sliding against his chest, and began to move the sheet downward to uncover him. It made him tremble. He watched the sheet slide down until the tip of his erection appeared. Kimmy’s lips slimmed at the sight, a certain satisfaction appearing on her face. Seeing him erect pleased her. But this was more than erect. An absolute throbbing iron rod stuck arrow-straight from between his legs, aching and hurting. He helped Kimmy, guiding the

sheet lower, wanting his wife to get a good look at what he had. The sheet tickled the underside of his erection, then slid over his balls, which had clumped into a tight bunch. Kimmy regarded his aroused manhood. His hips and ass flexed involuntarily, feeling his wife's eyes like she touched him. He ached for her to touch him. Wanted nothing more than for Kimmy to take a firm grip on his cock, maybe put him in her mouth.

He sighed a long dry and draggy sound, then closed it off with embarrassment. Kimmy nibbled her lower lip and lay her warm hand on his chest. She said, "I said to Devlin what I told you I would, and I recorded it."

"You did?"

"What would be the point in doing it if I didn't record it?"

"You really did this?"

Kimmy's hand slipped into her suit pocket and produced her phone. "I did, Josh. I shouldn't have, but I did. Do you want to hear it?"

There had been no doubt in his mind until now that he would listen to the recording. But now that his wife presented him with the option, he considered it. Was the recording so awful that he shouldn't hear it? Kimmy acted as though what she'd captured was terrible. What if it was too much for him to hear?

"I want to hear it," he said.

"I know you do," she said, thumb flicking through screens to find an app she searched for. She opened it, pressed play—then pressed pause again. She said, "Are you sure you want to hear this?"

"How bad is it?"

"It's pretty bad, Josh."

"Nothing happened though, right?"

Kimmy's sober expression changed to comical annoyance for a second. A peek behind her mask that made him think again she manipulated him, and enjoyed doing it.

If his amazing wife manipulated him, then he knew he was going to love what was on this recording.

If what she'd done was heinous, Kimmy had the choice not to tell him at all.

"Press play," he said.

Kimmy pressed play.

Acoustics

Josh's heart wedged in his throat as he listened to the recording play. Kimmy knocking on a door, Devlin answering. And, fuck, already she was engaged in their game: Devlin said to Kimmy he had something to show her and Kimmy said she wanted to see it. Though Josh's pulse raced and his heart pounded, he couldn't help chuckling through his nose at his wife's wordplay. Even Kimmy smiled, watching him lie in bed naked and listen to her recording.

There were the sounds of shoes on hardwood, a door closing. Josh asked her where this was. "His office?"

She shook her head no.

"Where?"

Kimmy whispered, "Devlin's apartment."

He shot up, scooting back, knees raised. He scowled at her, furious for some reason. "Where the fuck . . .?"

Kimmy paused the recording, but appeared reluctant. "His apartment, Josh."

"Where's his apartment?"

"Near the office."

"I didn't . . . He has an apartment near the office?"

“Yeah. I told you. He’s moving to Toronto.”

“You didn’t tell me he had an apartment.”

“Sure, I did. What does it matter, Josh? Don’t you want to listen?”

“You went to his apartment?”

“Yeah,” she said, brow furrowing.

“You’ve been there before?”

“Sure. A few times. What’s the big deal?”

His tightened stomach somehow found the space to turn over, and for a moment he thought this revelation might be too much to bear. It felt like betrayal—though it wasn’t. Devlin had an apartment near Kimmy’s office, so what?

After a few deep breaths, he was able to chuckle again, and he worked his way to lie down on the bed, but now he brought a sheet over to cover his crotch. “This is fucking crazy. You went to his apartment to do this?”

“He asked me to swing by. He’d already settled in for the night and wasn’t coming to the office. He asked me to stop on my way home to look at something.”

As his diaphragm relaxed a little and he slipped back into the here-and-now and this scenario his wife was setting up for his sexual pleasure, the excitement returned. This was a gift for him from Kimmy. He was beginning to think even this revelation of Devlin’s nearby apartment was timed for this event. And he wondered if what he heard on the recording would be anywhere near as bad as Kimmy suggested: was it merely hype for her husband’s benefit, hype to give some mediocre exchange between Kimmy and Devlin more weight just for his erotic enjoyment?

He said, “At lunch today, Devlin asked me what you’re like in bed.”

Kimmy's head cocked, brow lowered. And then she smiled. "What did you tell him?"

"The truth," Josh said. "That you're amazing."

"That's all? Just amazing?"

"Amazing isn't good enough?"

"Tell me what you told him," she said, her hand touching his hipbone. All five of her fingernails raked a gentle path from hipbone down his thigh, her pinky finger rustling the bedsheet covering his erection.

"I told him you're amazing. That you are always amazing. And . . ."

"And? . . ." Her nails dragged northward again, running up his thigh to his hipbone, nudging the bedding, making the fabric tickle on the underside of his throbbing cock.

"And how . . . How you're creative."

She smiled. "You told him I was creative?"

"I told him you're creative."

"Kinky, you mean."

"I don't think I used the word kinky. I told him . . . I told him you were always amazing, but that now you're wild."

"Wild," she repeated, looking up and thinking about the description. "I like wild, Josh."

Her dragging nails detoured, her fingers crawling underneath the fabric and the scooped edges of her nails dragging over his scrotum, which tightened further at her touch. He drew in a deep breath and flinched. His flinching made Kimmy laugh.

She said, "So you say I'm wild now."

“You disagree with me?”

“Not at all. I think you’re a little wild, too, Josh. What do you think of that?”

“Sounds like we were made for each other.”

Kimmy snuffled laughter, smiling again. “We are. We’re made for each other.”

“Definitely.”

“You ready to hear more?”

“I have a feeling you’re building this up to make me crazy.”

Kimmy’s smile faded. She said, “I’m making the best of something. Something I shouldn’t have done.”

“Don’t say that, Kimmy. It makes me feel like I forced you into something.”

“I don’t blame you at all, Josh. I did it. I did it because I like when you think I’m wild.”

He sat up, hands slinking around her waist. Him naked, her clothed, his palms sliding on the fine wool of her suit jacket. Their mouths connected, and he kissed her. Kimmy still held his shrunken scrotum in her fingers. She kissed and chuckled and breathed, and when their kiss broke apart, she touched her forehead to his. “Are you ready to hear more?”

“You went to all this trouble,” he said, “might as well get the show I paid for.”

“You didn’t pay anything,” she said, still smiling, pushing him back with her forehead. He lay back in the bedding, bundled sheets over his crotch, his wife’s hand tickling at his balls.

He said, “However bad it is, Kimmy, it doesn’t matter to me.”

Now her smile softened, and her eyes looked compassionate. Like she appreciated his words and their meaning. She nodded, lay her phone down on the bed next to him again, and pressed play.

He listened to Devlin and Kimmy making small talk in what he imagined was Devlin's apartment foyer. Probably some real impressive pad he had too, knowing Devlin. Super modern and expensive, and when he invited Kimmy over after work to 'show her something,' Josh was sure Devlin set the scene: a bottle of whiskey out. Maybe wine. Some soft music playing. All the lights set to dim. What was he wearing? A robe? Probably. He probably let it hang open. That's how Kimmy saw Devlin's penis again. He stiffened at the thought, and Kimmy responded by lightly tickling her nail tips on his balls again.

Josh said, "What was he wearing if he was expecting you?"

On Kimmy's phone, a conversation played out that meant nothing to him. No dirty talk, no double entendres, only dumb stuff about shipping and transportation and legal matters that he didn't care about.

Kimmy said, "He was dressed for work, Josh. But he had his suit jacket off and wasn't wearing a tie. Just his dress pants and an open dress shirt."

"Sleeves rolled up?"

Kimmy chuckled at his insight. "Yes, he had his sleeves rolled up."

"You know he preened for you."

"Because he knew I was coming?"

"You know it. He probably set the scene."

"His apartment is quite cozy."

"Cozy?—I don't picture Devlin in a cozy apartment."

"No, I mean it's big and spacious and everything, but the lights were nice."

“I knew it.”

Underneath their banter, more conversation played out regarding work. Josh stopped talking when he heard Devlin say, “Can I get you a glass of wine?” He bit on his lower lip as Kimmy stayed silent as well.

On the phone, Kimmy—in Devlin’s apartment—agreed to a glass of wine. Now he listened to small talk, Kimmy complimenting the view while Devlin poured them wine. They clinked glasses together and something about them being friendly this way really got under Josh’s skin in the worst—and yet best—possible way.

Now they weren’t talking about work anymore. Devlin asked Kimmy how she enjoyed Cayman. Kimmy told him all the things that she and her husband did, and Devlin grunted affirmations, sipping wine.

Josh whispered, “Where are you in his apartment?”

“In the living room. Standing between his couches.”

Josh smiled. “It just changed from business to pleasure.”

But Kimmy didn’t laugh this time. She chewed her lower lip nervously and there was an anxious jitter in her eyes looking back at him. It was the first time he thought maybe this wasn’t a ruse on her part. Maybe her statement of error wasn’t part of the game. Maybe she really did go too far.

A wonderful worry began to curl up low in his belly. A heavy, sick sort of feeling that wasn’t unwelcome. His thighs flexed and his cock bulged. Kimmy began to squeeze and knead his balls. He groaned and lay his head back on the pillow.

On the phone, Kimmy said, “That was quite the scene before our dinner.”

Devlin said, “How do you mean?”

“I mean when we went swimming.”

“What about it?”

Josh could picture that malevolent smile-dash-sneer on Devlin's handsome face. Not knowing that Kimmy planned to talk about his nudity, but looking for a chance to insinuate it himself.

This was wilder than Josh could ever have imagined. He shifted his pelvis forward, guiding Kimmy's hand from his balls onto his shaft. She knew what he wanted, and her fingers circled his shaft.

She whispered, "You're so fucking hard right now."

It brought a deeper groan and a tremendous flex of his manhood in her grip. He was pulsing out pre-come, and he tilted his tailbone down, trying to get his slippery lubricant in her grip.

Kimmy let him do it, held her hand still until the end of his cock passed into her grip. Her hand closed around the head of his cock, and he eased upward, pushing his now-slippery shaft into her clutch. Though she bit her lip nervously, she began to smile. She whispered, "Are you listening?"

"To every single fucking word, Kimmy."

"I don't want you to be upset."

"Whatever happens here, nothing can upset me."

"Do you swear?"

She began to stroke up and down. His head fell back on the pillow. "Oh my God, Kimmy, I am so one hundred percent fucking sure."

"I hope so, Josh. I did it for you."

Devlin and Kimmy were talking still on the phone, and he shushed her.

Kimmy stroked his cock slowly and whispered, "Sorry."

Devlin on the phone said, "That's the way it is there."

"I wasn't expecting nudity."

“You’re not surprised though.”

Kimmy, in Devlin’s apartment, drinking wine after work with him, giggled.
“No, I don’t think I was surprised at all.”

“Why bring it up then?”

“In front of my husband, Devlin?” She said it as though the answer should be obvious.

“Josh gets it. He stripped right down, ran around with his little dick stiff as a peg.”

This got Josh groaning again, and he humped his hand through his wife’s fist. Kimmy flung away the bedding that covered him, and they both watched her hand on his naked cock. A cock so dwarfed by her boss’s. And Kimmy and her boss were talking about it on the phone recording.

This was too wild to believe it was even really happening.

Kimmy said to Devlin, “You both hoped you could get me to disrobe.”

“Why should Josh get all the fun?”

“Seeing me without my clothes?”

“He’s one lucky man.”

“He is,” Kimmy said, then the sound of sipping wine.

“Next time we’re down in Cayman, I’d like it if you were comfortable enough to fit in.”

“It’s not a nudist resort, Devlin.”

“It’s private. It’s private and I make the rules.”

“What if I was offended by your nudity?”

“Were you?”

“Do you think it’s appropriate to disrobe in front of an employee?”

Devlin agreed. “Especially an employee who is a lawyer. But I have really big balls, Kimmy.”

There was a long beat of silence, and in that space Josh’s heart stopped. It was like they were flirting. In that silence, Josh knew Kimmy and Devlin both smiled at each other. Both enjoying this inappropriate time together.

“What the hell?” he gasped, not believing that Kimmy would be so bold to talk like this with Devlin. She was doing it for his sake. And the thing that aroused him most was the fear that Kimmy secretly enjoyed it. He fantasized she did as he pushed his cock in and out of her slippery hand. Every time his cock flexed, he pulsed new pre-come into her stroking.

Kimmy said to Devlin, “You definitely have big balls,” and Josh’s sex drive blasted off like a hypersonic missile.

Long Looks

Josh hissed, “I can’t believe you said that.”

Kimmy nodded, and the hand that wasn’t on his dick covered her mouth. It seemed like a gesture to hide a giggle, but her eyes didn’t show amusement. She knew it was bad.

Through clenched teeth, his wife still stroking his cock, he said, “I fucking love it.”

Kimmy showed relief now, her hand coming away from her mouth and rubbing his other thigh while she jerked him off.

Kimmy and Devlin shared a chuckle. The two of them making bawdy jokes together.

Josh said, “You’re flirting with him.”

Kimmy’s brow lowered. “No, I’m not.”

“I mean, you sound like you are. He must’ve thought you were.”

“You see? I went too far, Josh, I—”

“It’s not too far, I swear.”

“How am I supposed to work with Devlin now?”

“I told you Devlin’s okay with it.”

“But what about me?”

Kimmy was right. This was going too far. It didn't matter that her husband got off on it, this jeopardized her job and put her in an awkward position at work. He held her wrist for a moment, and though she couldn't stroke him now, her fingers teased. He said, "Are you okay?"

She nodded. "I'm okay."

"And I'm okay. What do you think's changed? What does Devlin think now?"

"Keep listening," she said.

The cast-aside look of despondence on her face sickened him again in that way he hated that he liked. Yes, there was more to the recording. Kimmy made a joke about seeing Devlin's big balls and this was her boss, and that was a bad thing to do, but there was more badness to come.

They'd just talked through Kimmy and Devlin on the recording, and he listened keenly now, up on an elbow, holding onto his wife's wrist while her thumb stroked circles on the underside of his cock head.

Devlin said about his large testicles, "I guess it's an open secret now," and Kimmy said, "You could barely hide them, anyway."

Another long moment of silence between the awful conversation's two participants in Devlin's apartment. Kimmy's thumb still stroked circles on the most sensitive spot on his penis. Josh stilled her thumb, and she looked at him nervously.

He said, "I don't want to come yet."

She nodded, at least happy to know that he hadn't stopped her because he was angry.

On the recording: "Well, now that we know, I don't think there's any big deal stripping down in Cayman. I don't do it at the office. This was a work-slash-vacation. I went swimming on the vacation segment of your trip. Now if I started coming into the office with my wang hanging out—"

“Tami would pass out.”

As Devlin and Kimmy both chuckled, Josh asked who Tami was.

“You know her. Tami, my secretary.”

“Does she have a thing for Devlin?”

Kimmy put a finger to her lips to remind him to be quiet.

Devlin was saying, “She probably would. You, you’re desensitized now. When we’re in Cayman next time, what’s the big deal? We already know Josh doesn’t care. And I don’t think you really care.”

“Don’t make assumptions.”

“Do you care?”

“Josh was there.”

Another beat of quiet, and Josh strained to hear.

Devlin said, “Your problem is I did it when your husband was there. You’d be all right if it were just the two of us alone?”

“I didn’t say that.”

“You’re right about one thing.”

“What’s that?”

“It was an odd time in Cayman together.”

“We had fun.”

“The three of us together, I mean. It was awkward.”

“Josh thought it was going to be just the two of us.”

“It could have been, but then it wasn’t.”

“You want all three of us to get along better. Is that why you took my husband out for lunch today?”

“You talked to him.”

“He texted me.”

“What did he tell you?”

“You guys are going to a Jays game.”

“This Friday. See, it was weird down in Cayman. I felt like a third wheel. I know that’s my fault. Josh has no reason to like me. High school was a long time ago. I took him out for lunch so we could bury the hatchet. Josh seems to be over it.”

“Josh is tough.”

Josh smiled and Kimmy smiled in return, both of them with their ears cocked toward her phone laying on the bed next to them.

Devlin said, “Another thing I picked up on in Cayman . . .”

“What?”

“You guys are up to something.”

“What do you mean?”

“I don’t have to tell you. You know. Even Josh knows.”

“He told you we were up to something?”

“And now you’re here in my apartment talking about my dick.”

“I’m not talking about that.”

The hell you aren't, Kimberly." The sound of a wineglass being put down. "I had lunch with your husband. We talked about you. Talked about your marriage."

"Our happy marriage."

"I wouldn't describe it any other way. And you wouldn't, either."

"I don't."

"But at dinner, the two of you had a game going."

"You're ridiculous."

"There's no way I'm ridiculous, there's no way I'm wrong about it. And I can prove it."

"How you can prove it, Devlin?" There was bemusement in Kimmy's voice. Kimmy's thumb-circling on the underside of his cock slowed. Josh looked at his wife's face, saw her nibbling on her lower lip. They must be getting close to where she said things went too far.

He removed her hand from his cock and sat up. He put one arm around her back, one hand on the narrow of her waist. She was still clothed, body warm under the cool fabric where his palm rested. She was trim and lean and the sexiest thing alive. Their shoulders touched. Her chin rested on his shoulder.

In Devlin's apartment a few hours ago, Devlin said to Kimmy, "I'm into games, too, Kimmy. I really like games."

"What game are we playing?"

"We're going to play a game of chicken."

"I like it in the apartment. I don't want to head out and find a lonely stretch of highway."

“This is my game of chicken. I know the game you were running. You two think you’re funny. Doing something together behind my back. And I’m your toy.”

“That might be the most ridiculous thing I’ve ever heard from a grown man.”

“Really? First time I see you since Cayman, you come to my apartment and after we talk about work, you can’t wait to talk about my dick.”

“Don’t be so high on yourself. I only mention it because—”

More quiet. Josh strained to hear, and Kimmy hugged him tighter. Now on the recording, Kimmy saying, “What are you doing?”

“Showing you what you came here to see.”

“Don’t you dare.”

“Stop me then.”

“This is your game of chicken?”

“We’re not at work. This is after hours and you are in my apartment. I’m not your employer and you’re not my employee. Not right now.”

“So what am I?”

“This is where we find out if Josh and Kimmy are playing a game with mean old Devlin Stone.”

“Don’t you dare. I’m serious.”

“‘Don’t you dare’ is not the same as ‘stop.’ Say it.”

“I can leave.”

“You can. You can do anything you want. But right now I’m going to take my dick out because I know you want to see it again.”

“You’re so full of yourself.”

Silence.

“Devlin . . .”

Silence again, and then the gut wrenching sound of a zipper being drawn down.

“Tell me when to stop.”

“Devlin, don’t do it.”

“Say stop.”

“Devlin . . .”

“Is this what you came for?”

The sound of Kimmy putting down her wine glass now.

Josh said, “Are you kidding me?”

Kimmy hugged him tighter and her chin dug into his collar.

“I can’t believe this,” Josh said.

“I’m sorry,” Kimmy whispered.

He rubbed a circle on her back and said, “I love you. Don’t tell me you’re sorry. Does he have it out?”

Kimmy nodded.

Devlin said, “There it is. Take a good look. You were shy when Josh was around.”

“Put it away.”

“Think of my apartment like that beach in Cayman. Clothing optional. Sometimes when I’m alone here and I’m walking around, I’ll take my dick out. What do you think?”

“I think you should put it away.”

“What did you and Josh say about it when you were alone?”

“It didn’t even come up.”

Devlin chuckled.

“Stop it.”

Devlin said, “I heard you.”

“You’re going to put it away?”

“I heard you in Cayman with Josh. Quite the show you two put on.”

“I don’t know what you’re talking about.”

“Your sex sounds, Kimmy. You guys had to run up from the beach for a quickie.”

“You weren’t supposed to hear us.”

“No, I’m sure it was an accident that the windows were open and you were hollering out.”

“You shouldn’t have listened. . . . What are you doing now?”

“Getting comfortable.”

“Devlin, it’s enough.”

“All right,” Devlin said.

Josh whispered to Kimmy, “What was he doing?”

“Unbuttoning his shirt.”

Devlin’s boldness drove Josh out of his mind. A rage filled him, and though it should be directed at Devlin, it was scattered. A raw feeling of hurt and jealousy broadcast in a wide scope instead of a narrow pinpoint on Devlin Stone’s chest. He could blame Devlin Stone for this, but he’d brought it on himself. Dumped it on to Kimmy and now Kimmy had done this to please him. And all that Devlin did was give them what he thought they wanted.

Josh held Kimmy tight and, feeling his grip around her tighten, she clutched him harder as well. But her hand slipped down his belly and gripped his cock. Her touch had it jolting and sending up a small geyser of pre-come. When it spilled over his wife’s hand, she gasped with lust.

“Oh my God,” he said, his voice constricted. Hugging her tight, cross-legged, Kimmy on her hip with one hand stroking his cock. He was seconds away from exploding. “Slow, slow, slow,” he told her.

Devlin said, “You still didn’t tell me to stop.”

“Yes, I did.”

“You want me to put it away?”

Silence.

“Nodding isn’t yes, Kimmy.”

“I’m sorry,” she whispered again into Josh’s ear.

Devlin said, “You can look.”

More silence. Kimmy looking directly at Devlin’s big penis pulled out of his pants. Josh knew what it looked like, could picture it hanging out of the dark wool V of zipped-down suit pants, a heavy sagging club. “You were looking at it?”

Kimmy didn’t nod or say anything.

Devlin said, “You want to see it hard now? Bet you wonder what it looks like hard.” His voice was low and devilish, a confident grumble. And in its wake, nothing but silence. And in that long silence, Josh pictured Kimmy nodding yes. Kimmy indicating to Devlin Stone she wanted to see what his cock looked like hard.

When the silence endured, it was like a confirmation. Josh wheezed, “Are you kidding me?”

Kimmy stiffened, and he soothed a hand on her back again.

“What’s happening?”

“He’s playing with it.” Her voice trembled.

“What are you doing?”

She shook her head no.

“You’re watching?”

The dabbing point of her chin on his collar got his balls climbing high up inside his body. The soothing hand on her back stilled and he held her close. She’d done this for him because she thought he wanted it. Kimmy had stood and watched Devlin Stone get the upper hand, turn the tables on them.

Josh said, “Really?”

No answer from Kimmy. Then Devlin said, “I’ll get you desensitized. On the beach that day, your husband’s little bean was straight as an arrow. He’s a free man. I’m a free man. I didn’t know you’d be so repressed.”

“I’m not repressed.”

“You’re just like that little girl who ran out of my basement.”

“I don’t want to talk about that.”

“You’re all grown up now. Kimmy Chang is more woman than any other I’ve seen. She’s got everything.”

“I’m not repressed.”

“So then, what’ll happen next time we’re in Cayman?”

There was a gross shuffling sound that Josh was sure was Devlin’s palm on his cock. He whispered to Kimmy, “Is he getting hard?”

Kimmy hissed, “Yes.”

Josh held her back to look at her face. Her lips wriggled, and she looked like she might burst into tears. He held her neck and rubbed thumbs on her jawline, smiling at her. “I love it, Kimmy. Don’t be upset. I totally love it.”

Kimmy twisted her face away but held onto his wrists, circling her thumbs on them. “How can I go back to work now?”

“It’s all fine, Kimmy. Devlin did it, he—”

“There’s more,” she said.

The fact there was more chilled him. And he listened now, Devlin saying, “That’s it. Kimmy’s not repressed. She’s a grown ass woman that can cut men in half by looking at them.”

Josh said, “What’s happening?”

Kimmy shook her head no.

“What are you doing?”

Kimmy unbuttoned her dress shirt, one button and another, until he saw her navel. She wore no bra, and a sudden punch low in his belly told him his wife went without one on purpose. Hoping this would happen. “You’re not wearing a bra.”

She shook her head no.

Devlin said, “That’s it, show it. Show me, look at my cock growing. You came to see it, look at it.”

The hair rose on the back of Josh’s neck. “Did you take your clothes off?”

Kimmy shook her head again and pulled aside her shirt to reveal her nipple.

“You showed him your nipple?”

Kimmy nodded and lip-wriggled again, her eyes squeezed into tiny lines.

He grabbed the back of Kimmy’s thin neck and pulled her close. “You went to his apartment without a bra.” His heart raced in his chest.

She nodded. “For your sake. I was just going to tell you that I didn’t—”

“But you really didn’t.”

“I didn’t want this to happen, Josh.”

Josh swallowed. “Did you fuck him?” His voice was thin and disbelieving.

Kimmy slapped his chest lightly. “No, Josh.”

“He got hard while you showed your breast.”

Kimmy tried to put her arms around his neck and hug him, but he shoved her back. He got on top of her, Kimmy laying her back on the bed. All her dressed-up confidence falling away, naked Josh taking over. He reached down and grabbed her knee, slid his hand up the front of her thigh and then the inside, up underneath her skirt to find her naked. Her pussy flooded with her juices. When his fingers went through her folds, she howled a garbled sound.

“Fuck, Kimmy, oh my fucking God, holy fuck,” he said, heart galloping in his chest, eyes wild, the most focused and frenzied moment of passion he’d ever felt in his life. A veritable cupid’s arrow piercing his heart and flooding it with the poison of everlasting love. That this woman would do something so terrible for his benefit detonated in his brain. He clambered on top of her,

naked, his wife wearing the work clothes she'd worn to visit a man who'd become his sexual fetish. She'd shown that man her breast and recorded his reaction while he jerked his cock to hardness.

Near Kimmy's ear, he growled, "Devlin got hard for you."

"Yes," she gasped, writhing on the bed underneath him.

The point of his cock found her overflowing aperture, spearing inside her wet interior. Their union made a quick squelching sound, crowded out by Kimmy's cries of ecstasy. His fingers went through her fingers, the two of them upside down on the bed, their hands above them, his cock fully inside her. He pounded her deeply. Gave her every bit of his hugest, hardest size.

"I fucking love you," he said, wanting any hurt his wife might feel to be extinguished right away. "I fucking love you so much."

"Josh," she gasped, "I love you, too." The recording still played out, a shuffling sound while he fucked his wife. It was Devlin's manual accompaniment, showing off to Kimmy the size of his manhood. And Josh in the here-and-now, bringing her to orgasm.

Kimmy came while they both listened to Kimmy revealing her nipple to another man while he jerked off. Josh fucked Kimmy right through her orgasm, fucked her till her heels locked around his back.

Kimmy's hand reached down for her phone, shut it off, closed them in silence but for their own sounds.

"I wanted to listen," he gasped.

"It's just you and me, baby," she said. "Just you and me."

Two Hours Ago

The insanity of what they were doing had her heart racing in the red zone. Danger had never thrilled her more. Even if she never got the nerve to play this recording for Josh, the act of recording it might drive her mad.

Here alone with Devlin in his apartment, a secret passageway leading from this moment to Josh's ears.

Outside of Devlin's kitchen, they stood face to face, a half-dozen feet apart. Devlin had his cock out, half-aroused. The thing was enormous. Josh had never seen it hard. She thought of ways to introduce into this recorded conversation with Devlin a description of what she saw, but she could devise nothing that wouldn't break credulity. She would describe it to Josh, whisper it in his ear while they fucked later.

If she ever got the nerve to play this recording for him.

Josh, I've never seen anything like it. When it's hard, it wags between his legs like a horse's cock. When it's fully hard, a fistful's length of shaft behind the head is a brighter color than the darker shaft. He is really hung like a horse.

Her shirt was pulled to one side. Part of the act. Showing Devlin her bare breast. Devlin regarded her hungrily. Playing the game. Not wrecking it by going too far, but still offering enough to surprise her. His wariness of Josh's psyche was impressive. They'd never even discussed how this performance would go.

Devlin stepped closer now, and she re-covered her bared breast protectively. She said, “Stay on your side.”

“Tell me when to stop, Kimmy. I still haven’t heard you tell me to stop.”

“Don’t come closer. Don’t let that thing touch me,” she said, smiling at Devlin.

Devlin smiled back. “You can stop me anytime you want.” He came closer still, that impressive cock wagging out ahead of him, halfway down his thighs.

She said, “If that thing touches me, I’ll scream.”

“I’m sure you will. I’ve heard how you scream. And that’s with Josh’s little dick. What do you think the noises would be like if I turned you around, bent you over that couch and fucked you from behind?”

“I think we’re crossing a line here, Devlin,” she said, already in the editing process. This was too far. If Josh heard this, he would insist they call the police and consult a human resources lawyer. She smiled and put up a hand for Devlin, indicating their theater was over. But Devlin persisted, coming close enough his cock dragged on her bare leg.

He pulled her close, loomed above her, his handsome face over hers. He said, “When is it going to be my turn?”

“Your turn for what?”

“My turn to take you into a bedroom and fuck noises out of you that Josh can hear all the way down at the beach. Should we do it in Cayman?”

She played along, though Josh would never hear this. She said, “Fair is fair.”

“That’s the spirit. You talk to Josh. Tell him you want it. Tell him you want this . . .”

Devlin took her by the wrist and held out her hand below their belt lines. He slapped his cock into her palm, purposely producing a loud sticky skin-on-skin slap. Josh would crumble to dust if he heard it.

The thought of Josh listening to this drove her so wild her knees went weak and her thighs shook. She gripped Devlin's huge cock and said, "This would make me scream."

"I would love to hear you scream," he said, and brushed his fingers through her hair above her ear. Her nipples hardened further.

She said, "You're so much bigger than Josh."

"You were curious and now you know. You like it?"

"I'm scared of it."

"Don't be scared, Kimmy," he said, tracing fingers through her hair again. "Trust me, this will be the best fuck you've ever had. What you have in your hand is going to become your best friend. When you sleep at night you're going to dream of it."

She snuffled laughter and covered her mouth with her hand in case Josh heard that and knew they were teasing him. But Josh could never hear the recording this far. She would delete it. And if she had any sense, Josh would never hear a single second of this crazy idea she had. Recording her with Devlin to tease her husband was only for her.

Devlin leaned closer, and she arched her back until he bent her over the side table at the back of one of his couches. He kissed her, and she kissed him back, wet smacking sounds, moans. She imagined how hard Josh would get if he ever heard this. She began to stroke and manipulate Devlin's cock. It was huge, but not yet turgid. It was hard enough to fuck her, but when she stroked, it bobbed and swung. She stroked and kissed until he grew all the way hard. "Holy shit," she gasped around their kissing. "You're so huge."

Devlin sidestepped with her, unbuttoned her shirt, then thumbed at her nipples. She moaned and gasped, reached into her pocket and took out her

phone. Before she could thumb-close the recording, Devlin's hand gripped her wrist. "Keep it going," he whispered in her ear, and guided her by the wrist to set the phone down on the side table. "What would Josh do if he heard this?"

She looked up at his devious smile, her nipples alert, engorged and hurting, the open hems of her silky dress shirt brushing against their swollen sides. Devlin whisked her around to face away from him and bent her over the couch. She grabbed a pillow, held it to her chest and chin and Devlin raised her skirt.

Devlin growled with pleasure. "No panties. You came prepared. Came to see my cock and knew what you wanted me to do with it." He beat his erect penis on both her ass cheeks, then dragged the huge cock head through her sopping wet folds.

She bit the pillow, then gasped out, "Are you going to fuck me?"

"I haven't had this pussy in a week, and it's all I thought about every day." He pushed it inside her, and the size of his cock head alarmed her. A week without him, and his size could still surprise her. She kicked off her high-heeled shoes, imagining laying in bed and having the courage to play the recording this far, whispering to Josh while she jerked off his cock: "Those were my shoes hitting the floor."

What would Josh think? She suspected his head would pop like an overfilled balloon. And combined with that riling thought, Devlin eased half his huge cock inside her and got her babbling, air rushing into her lungs. It felt incredible. Her nails dug into the pillow and she bit it again. Devlin pulled back, a slick sound from her pussy she hoped her phone's recorder picked up. When he shoved in again, she came.

It was the bewildering badness of this situation. The absolute high-stakes danger that thrilled her like nothing ever before. It was more than just Devlin. It was Devlin and Josh, multiplied by the most lubricious sexual feelings she'd ever had in her life. She came and came again, pussy flexing, then quivering and flexing again. Devlin fucked her faster, the squelching liquid sounds making everything better. Or worse. Not going deep, but

giving her more than half of what he had, already more cock than anyone man should have.

Now she babbled and moaned, playing it up, fantasizing that Josh could hear her getting fucked this way. Getting pleasure that Josh could never give her. But in her core, somewhere just below her heart muscle, burned a coal-fired diamond of knowledge: she couldn't be with Devlin without Josh. Not for real. The only cement that held her together with this asshole she didn't even really like was the buttery pleasure derived from Josh's sexual torment. Had it always been about that?

Never in her life had she ever been this kind of terrible human being. Never before had she desired Devlin Stone. At Tiffany's party, she clearly hated Devlin Stone. After Tiffany's party, she clearly hated Devlin Stone. The only thing that brought her together with him was Josh's fear that it would happen.

She came again, gasping out and crying. Devlin slowed, letting her trembling pussy milk him. He undid her bun, twirled his hand in the loosening hair and fisted it. He pulled. She cried out and grabbed her own hair to relieve the tearing pain. And now Devlin fucked her hard. With a fistful of her hair, her back arched, bent over his leather couch, he gave her everything. Hard and fast. Her thighs shook, her ass cheeks bounced, her small breasts jittered. She gripped his hand that held her hair, her other claw clamped on the pillow to support her weight. She came again.

Devlin growled, knowing she was coming. And she pictured now Josh not listening, but sitting in Devlin's leather chair across from the couch. Sitting there watching his wife used and abused, getting turned inside out by his high school bully's horse cock. Watching her body writhe and twist with pleasure, listening to his wife's ecstatic gasps. Josh would come right in his pants.

"Oh God, oh God, oh God!"

This time when she came her stomach muscles went iron, and she cramped and twisted, trying to alleviate the pain that came with the hugest orgasm of the night. She felt Devlin's massive size inside her glide with renewed ease

as her orgasm flooded her canal. Devlin roared with mighty masculine pleasure. She gasped and cried, shouted out for him to come inside her.

Devlin loved it, letting her hair go and folding over her back. He supported her weight with his muscular forearms folded in an X over her chest. “You want my come in your belly?”

“Come inside me,” she said.

“You want it?”

“Come deep inside me.”

His cock probed deeper, provoking an uncomfortable feeling as his manhood rolled over parts inside her that only Devlin ever touched. Then he was deep as he could go, and she stilled, not wanting that uncomfortable feeling to return. Devlin’s thrusting became minuscule. As his cock began to flex and bulge inside her, she came again. A little one this time, but the ecstasy had exhausted her. She slumped on the couch, bare feet on his hardwood floor, not even supporting her weight now. Then he humped—not pulling or pushing, just throbbing. He was coming inside her.

She grabbed his hands and dragged her nails over the backs of them. “I feel you coming,” she gasped.

Devlin growled and grunted, and his cock continued to pulse inside her. The fullness was incredible. The depth was incredible. Every fold and corner inside her had been pushed out and stretched to full tightness. And his cock continued to jet his semen all the way into the furthest reaches of her insides.

The two of them at last collapsed, exhausted. Devlin’s hands flat on the couch seat, on either side of the pillow. They both gasped and panted for air. Then she began to chuckle.

“That was worth waiting a week for,” she said.

“You’re the fucking hottest woman I’ve ever met in my whole life.”

“Thank you,” she said, then wondered if he fished for compliments in return. She let it go. Devlin was a big boy, and she didn’t need to worry about his ego.

Devlin eased off her back, both of their bodies flushed and hot, sticky with sweat. He eased his cock out of her, let the head nestle in her entrance, and stroked out the last of his seed. But when he pulled out, a flatulent burble sent a splatter of his come down the inside of her thigh.

It took her half a minute to work herself to stand upright. Devlin stood before her, confident and masculine and full of himself. His cock wagged, one hand kneading his balls. He said, “Get on your knees.”

She showed him her own confident face, but lowered to her knees before him. He held upright his cock, the head of it above his navel. She kissed his hanging balls, pulled one of them into her mouth.

Devlin let his heavy cock drop on her face. It had weight.

She ran her tongue up the underside and put him in her mouth and continued to suck the rest of his come. He admired her while she did, and he said, “If Josh could see you now.”

She laughed around his cock, pulled it out, and wiped her lips with the back of her hand. She held up the hand and Devlin helped her to stand. She limped sideways to the table where her phone sat. Turning one knee outward to look down the inside of her thigh, where his semen dribbled in rivulets below her knee. She said, “I need to have a shower.”

“Let me join you.”

She chuckled and turned off the recording.

Unbroken

Kimmy pulled her skirt down to mid-thigh, sat up, and scooted to the edge of the bed. Josh hated her enervated gait heading to the closet. Defeated. As she flicked on the closet light, he pulled the bedding around his nakedness and said, “Do you blame me?”

Kimmy rested her hands on the dresser top and looked over at him. “No, Josh, not at all.”

“I feel like I’m to blame,” he said.

“I’m a big girl and I make my own decisions,” she said, slipping off her jacket and putting it on a hanger.

He said, “Yeah, but I was the one who made you have to decide.”

“No, that’s not true.” Kimmy faced away from him and undid all the buttons on her shirt. She shrugged it off and threw it in the laundry hamper, now topless. She paused again, like she was thinking. She said, “It wasn’t entirely for you.”

It puzzled him, and he asked her what she meant. She unzipped her skirt and let it fall to the floor. He watched her beautiful body as she stooped, picked up the skirt and tossed it in the hamper as well. She touched between her legs, testing the flow of his wetness from her. She snatched clean pajamas, held them under her arm and flicked off the light. It was a simple act, but one of the most erotic things he’d ever seen.

“Who else was it for, Kimmy?”

She touched the tip of her tongue to the corner of her mouth and rolled her eyes up to the ceiling, hand on one hip, hip jutted out. “Who do you think?”

“Devlin?”

Kimmy shook her head at him, an awkward smile tucked to one side. “What’s the matter with you?” She went in the bathroom and closed the door behind her. He heard the toilet lid flip up and the sound of her peeing.

“Oh,” he said to himself. “You.” He called out louder so she could hear: “You?”

Kimmy flushed the toilet. She brushed her teeth, did some cleaning, and when she came out, she wore pajama pants and an oversized T-shirt. She crawled up the bottom of the bed toward him.

He said it again, “You?”

“Is that bad?”

“No, that’s not what I meant. What do you mean it was for you?”

“Not me, Josh,” she said. “Not me only. Us. I did it for us.”

“You did it for me.”

“I did for us, Josh. You don’t think I enjoy this?”

“I was more flattered when I thought you were doing it just for me.”

“Well, then it would be your fault. Is that what you want?”

“See, you’re mad at me.”

“I’m not mad at all, Josh. I’m just at a loss. What the hell is tomorrow going to be like now? If Devlin comes into the Toronto office, what do I say? What does he say? What do I say after whatever it is he says?”

“It won’t be a big deal. I’m telling you, what he did in his apartment he’s probably done in front of other girls hundreds of times.”

“He won’t forget though.”

“But it’s probably not a big deal to him, Kimmy.”

“What will he think of you then, Josh? Your wife flashed her nipple at him while he showed off his cock.”

“Fuck,” Josh said, his stomach turning over. He lay a hand over it and hunched forward. A nauseous wave came up his back, thinking about what had happened tonight. Thinking about what Kimmy saw.

“What’s wrong with you?”

“I don’t feel so great.”

Kimmy rubbed her hand on his back. After a long moment, she said, “I’m not mad at you, Josh. I’m not mad at me and I’m not mad at Devlin. Like I said, I’m a big girl and I make my own decisions.”

“If there’s anybody I know that could think their way out of this, it’s you,” he murmured.

“Right?” she said, her tone more positive.

He stared at the pattern on the bedding, and that nauseous feeling didn’t leave his stomach. He said, “You saw Devlin get hard.”

She said nothing, but he could tell she nodded.

“I can’t believe it really happened.”

“Now we’ve got one for our memory bank. As soon as I get over this icky feeling about what I did, maybe we can enjoy it better.”

“You’re going to be fine at work.”

“Devlin is going to persist. He’ll think I’m into him.”

“You can resist him.”

She chuckled. “I know I can resist him.”

“Don’t worry about it,” he said, thinking now of Kimmy with her shirt open, baring a secret part of her, opening a window of possibilities to Devlin Stone. Devlin taking his dick out because he wants to fuck Kimmy. And now they were on the path for that to happen. But that could never happen. That was something he couldn’t recover from. But the thought of it brought his deflated cock back to life. It grew hard. He hid the erection away so Kimmy couldn’t see, and said, “What did it look like?”

Kimmy breathed for a little while but didn’t answer. Then softly, “You mean his penis?”

“You watched it get hard. What was it like?”

“Really huge, Josh. Weird. Way too big.”

He chewed his lower lip. “Did you . . . like it?”

Kimmy sighed. “What am I supposed to say?”

He reeled from that answer. She was supposed to say no. I hate his big gross cock. I hate him. But what she just said wasn’t that. “You did like it,” he said.

“No, I didn’t.”

“You can say you did if you did.”

“I don’t know what you want from me, Josh.”

“Just tell me the truth,” he said, his neck creaking to the left so he could spy her. She gave him a compassionate look, her lips tucked inward.

She said, “It’s . . . I mean, yeah.”

“Yeah, you like it?”

Now she was perturbed. She ran a hand through her hair. She looked away.

“Yeah, I liked it.”

“Good,” Josh said, nodding. The gorge rose from his stomach into his throat. “Good,” he said again.

“Where are you going?”

“Bathroom,” he said, dragging the quilt along with him so she couldn’t see his bare behind. He closed himself in the bathroom and flipped up the toilet seat and knelt where Kimmy just peed. Elbows on the seat, he hung his head over the toilet. His stomach still swirled, but nothing came up. He yawned and looked up at the ceiling, wanting his stomach to turn over so he wouldn’t feel so fucking sick. After a minute, he did it himself, sticking his finger down his throat and tickling the back until he hurled up everything he had at lunch with Devlin and dinner alone. His erection faded. He blew his nose, flushed the toilet and brushed his teeth. He fished out old pajamas from the hamper so he wouldn’t have to cross naked where she would see him. She’d seen a huge penis tonight that she liked. Maybe she didn’t like the guy it was attached to, but come on, the guy was handsome, and rich, and apparently smart. And he had a massive dick that Kimmy liked.

When he came out of the bathroom, Kimmy was lying in bed with her back toward the center. He slipped in behind her, cuddled to her back and tucked an arm across her chest. She held onto his thumb.

Josh said, “Can you play the rest now?”

“That’s all there was, Josh. I told you.” He sighed. He was too embarrassed to ask to play it again from the beginning. The recording did awful things to his brain and his body, but his sexual psyche responded. The reality of what happened tonight was dark and provocative, but should never have transpired.

He had to be the savior here, had to be strong for her sake and support her. He said, “I’m glad at least that you got something out of it, that . . . that it’s

not all me.”

“It’s not all you, baby.” She squeezed his thumb with three gentle pulses.
“Turning you on turns me on. Even when I’m not here in bed with you.”

“You’re the best,” he said and kissed the back of her ear.

“Should we tell him?”

He said, “Tell him what?”

“That we were playing a game, and that I did all this on the recording for you.”

“No, don’t do that.”

Kimmy shook her head in a way that made him think it wasn’t the answer she wanted to hear. He said, “Maybe like a little or something.”

“Tell him what?”

“That you and I can be kinky sometimes, and this one got away from us. But that’s all. No details.”

“He’s not going to back down or stop now that he knows this isn’t a bad thing. It’s an excuse for him to be bad. Every time I see him now, he’s going to try something. And if I tell him to stop, he will, but he’ll laugh it off like it’s all a big joke.”

“We’ll deal with it. And I know you can handle him. He needs you.”

Kimmy sighed. “Yeah, he does. Thank God.”

“Put him in his place if you have to. If there’s anyone that can, it’s you.”

Kimmy chuckled, and he hugged her. She said, “What was the grift he ran on you? About humiliation or something. That psychobabble he talks.”

“Oh, just . . . just dumb stuff about how humiliation is a lesson and shit like that.”

“Why were you talking about humiliation?”

He kissed the back of her ear again. “He blames Amy for all the stuff at the party and the texting.”

“Yeah, he told me that, too. Do you think he’s right?”

“I don’t know, Kimmy. I really don’t care anymore. If it was Amy, who gives a shit. She lives in London and she’s creepy. Did she taunt me? Maybe. And if it was Devlin who did it, well, that’s what Devlin does. Mean shit like that. I think things have changed, either way. There are no more texts and I’m happy with the way things worked out. I like where I’m at now.”

Kimmy quarter-faced him, smirking. “So humiliation really is a gift?”

He laughed and squeezed her. “Shit, maybe Devlin’s right. . . . No, I’m not letting them humiliate me.”

“Good, baby,” she said, squeezing his thumb again. “You really like where you are?”

He thought about it, knowing without a doubt that he did, but wanting to find the right words for her, to put her mind at ease. “I’ve never been happier, Kimmy. I’ve never felt better about my life and what we’re doing together. I’ve never felt closer to you.”

Kimmy hugged his arm tight and said, “I’m glad, Josh. I think you’re right.”

He said, “And I think this is just the beginning.”

Afterword

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